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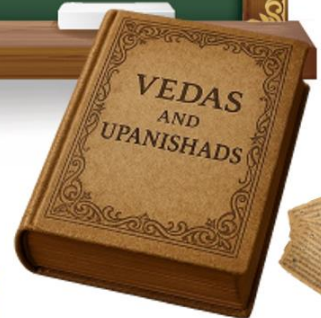
UPSC

History

Prelims

Vedic Period
&
Literature

With PYQ's



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Vedic Period

From Harappan to Vedic Age :

- The **Harappan Civilization** (c. 2600–1900 BCE) declined due to factors like climate change, tectonic activities, drying of rivers (especially Saraswati), and economic disintegration.
- Following the Harappan decline, the **Vedic Civilization** emerged, which marked a **shift from urban to rural life**.
- The **Vedic Age** is primarily reconstructed from **Vedic literature**, especially the **Rig Veda**, but supplemented by archaeological evidence (e.g., Painted Grey Ware Culture).
- The **Vedic Age** spans from **c. 1500 BCE to 600 BCE** and is divided into:
 - **Early Vedic Period / Rig Vedic Period (1500–1000 BCE)**
 - **Later Vedic Period (1000–600 BCE)**
- **Indo-Aryans**, credited with composing the Vedic texts, were **semi-nomadic pastoralists** who gradually settled in the northwestern plains and expanded into the Gangetic plains.
- The **transition** from Harappan to Vedic marked:
 - Urban → Rural society
 - Mother Goddess worship → Male deities (like Indra, Agni)
 - Scripted culture (Indus Script) → Oral culture (Vedas)
 - Trade & city life → Agriculture & cattle-based economy

Origin of the Aryans

- **‘Aryan’** means “noble” or “best”; derived from **Sanskrit root ‘ar’ (to cultivate)**.
- Initially a **linguistic and cultural identity**, not racial.
- **Spoke Indo-European languages**, with **Sanskrit** as their primary language in India.

Theories on Aryan Origin

Theory	Proposed Homeland	Key Supporters	Basis	Remarks
1. European Theory	Europe (e.g., Germany, Hungary)	Sir William Jones, Schroeder, Nehring	Linguistic similarities between Sanskrit and European	Earliest theory based on comparative philology

			languages (e.g., matri – mater)	
2. Central Asian Theory	Central Asia	Max Müller, E. Meyer	Linguistic and cultural parallels between Vedas and Avesta (Zoroastrian text)	Most widely accepted theory
3. Arctic Theory	Arctic Region	Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Vedic references to long days and nights (6 months)	Based on astronomical references
4. Tibetan Theory	Tibet	Swami Dayanand Saraswati	Interpretation of Vedic texts	Less accepted, lacks archaeological backing
5. Indigenous Theory	India (Sapta Sindhu)	A.C. Das, Dr. Sampurnanand, R.B. Pandey	Vedic texts mention rivers of Punjab; Flora-fauna matches with Indian subcontinent	Lacks archaeological and linguistic backing
6. Southern Russian / Steppe Theory	Southern Russia / Eurasian Steppes (Andronovo Culture)	Most modern scholars	Evidence from Bactria-Margiana Archaeological Complex (BMAC); Horse, spoked wheels, fire cults	Currently dominant and widely accepted

Evidence Supporting Steppe-Origin Theory

- **Andronovo Culture** (Southern Siberia): Semi-nomadic people with horse domestication, chariots.
- **Bactria–Margiana Archaeological Complex (BMAC)**: Cultural zone north of the Hindu Kush, showing connections with Vedic rituals.
- Artifacts showing **cremation, fire worship, horse usage, and spoked wheels** — all associated with early Vedic Aryans.
- **Mitanni and Kassite inscriptions** (Syria, Iraq): Use of Aryan names and gods like Indra, Varuna, Mitra around 1600–1400 BCE.
- **Rig Veda** uses the term '**Arya**' ~36 times; denotes **cultural identity**, not race.

Sapta Sindhu Region

- **Sapta Sindhu** = "Land of Seven Rivers"; considered the **earliest homeland** of the Aryans in India.
- The term '**Sindhu**' (Indus) is referred to as the **river par excellence** in Vedic literature.
- The Aryans likely established **political dominance** in the region due to:
 - Use of **horse-drawn chariots**
 - **Superior military technology**

Seven Rivers of Sapta Sindhu:

- | | |
|--------------------------------|--|
| 1. Sindhu – Indus River | 5. Purushni – Ravi |
| 2. Vitasta – Jhelum | 6. Sutudri – Sutlej |
| 3. Vipasa – Beas | 7. Saraswati – (identified with modern Ghaggar-Hakra) |
| 4. Askini – Chenab | |

- Region corresponds to **eastern Afghanistan, Punjab, and western fringes of Uttar Pradesh**.

Evidence from Rig Veda:

- **Yamuna** is mentioned **twice**, and **Ganga** only **once**.
 - Suggests the **Rig Vedic Aryans had not yet migrated eastward** into the **Ganga-Yamuna Doab**.
- Indicates that early Aryan settlements were **confined to the northwestern part** of the Indian subcontinent.

Vedic Literature

I. Classification of Vedic Literature

Vedic literature is broadly divided into:

Category	Period	Key Texts
Early Vedic Literature	c. 1500–1000 BCE	Rigveda (Books II–VII – Family Books)
Later Vedic Literature	c. 1000–500 BCE	Rigveda (Books I, VIII, IX, X), Samaveda, Yajurveda, Atharvaveda, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads

- **Veda:** Derived from root *vid* (to know); considered **Shruti** (revealed texts), orally transmitted for centuries.
- Each Veda has four major parts:
 - **Samhita** – Mantras/hymns
 - **Brahmana** – Ritual texts
 - **Aranyaka** – Forest texts
 - **Upanishad** – Philosophical treatises

II. The Four Vedas

1. Rigveda

- **Oldest Veda;** earliest Indo-Aryan literature.
- **Total hymns:** 1,028, in **10 Mandalas**.
- **Language:** Early Sanskrit.
- **Content:** Hymns in praise of deities like **Agni, Indra, Soma**.
- **Significance:**
 - Mandalas II–VII: *Family books* (Vishvamitra, Atri, Vasishtha, etc.).
 - Mandala IX: Soma hymns.
 - Mandala X: Contains *Purusha Sukta* (origin of four varnas).
 - Mandala I: Philosophical and cosmological hymns.
- **Priest:** *Hotri* (reciter of hymns).
- **Upaveda:** *Ayurveda*
- **Recension:** Only surviving one – *Shakala Shakha*.
- **UNESCO status:** Declared a part of World Human Heritage.

2. Samaveda

- Derived from **Rigveda hymns**, but set to **melody and chant**.
- **Total verses**: 1,810
- Purpose: Sung during **sacrifices** by *Udgatar* priests.
- **Important Feature**: Basis of Indian classical music; contains early *Dhrupad Raga*.
- **Upaveda**: *Gandharva Veda* (music & performing arts).
- **Recensions**: *Kauthuma*, *Jaiminiya* (*Talavakara*), *Ranayaniya*

3. Yajurveda

- **Manual for ritual performance**; includes sacrificial formulas.
- Two major divisions:
 - **Shukla (White)** – Mantras only; *Madhyandina* & *Kanva* recensions.
 - **Krishna (Black)** – Mantras + prose commentary; *Kathaka*, *Taittiriya*, etc.
- **Priest**: *Adhvaryu* (executor of rituals).
- **Upaveda**: *Dhanurveda* (military science).

4. Atharvaveda

- **Most diverse**: Hymns + magical spells, healing charms, domestic rituals.
- **Total hymns**: 711 in 20 books (*Kandas*).
- **Nature**: Practical, mystical, and magical.
- Considered **non-Aryan influence** by some scholars.
- **Upaveda**: *Shilpa Veda* (architecture, engineering).
- **Recensions**: *Shaunaka* & *Paippalada*
- **Associated Brahmana**: *Gopatha Brahmana*

III. Brahmanas

- **Prose explanations** of Samhita hymns.
- Detail **rules, rituals, and ceremonies** of sacrifices.
- **Most important**: *Shatapatha Brahmana* (attached to Yajurveda) – describes "100 paths of truth".
- Reflect **orthodox ritualism**.

IV. Aranyakas

- Known as '**Forest Books**' – composed by reclusive hermits.
- Serve as **transition** from ritualism to **philosophical thought**.
- Emphasize **meditation, symbolism**, and internalization of sacrifice.
- Conclude Brahmanas; precursor to the Upanishads.

V. Upanishads (Vedanta)

Feature	Details
Meaning	"To sit near a teacher" (for esoteric knowledge)
Focus	Metaphysics: <i>Atman, Brahman, Karma, Moksha</i>
Total	108 Upanishads; 13 principal (e.g., Brihadaranyaka, Chandogya)
Shift	From ritual to philosophical introspection
Key Teachings	Unity of soul (<i>Atman</i>) with cosmic soul (<i>Brahman</i>)
Notable Concepts	<i>Satya (Truth), Satyamev Jayate</i> (from Mandukya)
Social Views	Discuss <i>ashrama system</i> , marriage types (e.g., <i>anuloma, pratiloma</i>)

VI. Vedanga (Limbs of the Vedas)

Vedanga	Subject
Shiksha	Phonetics
Kalpa	Ritual procedures (includes Shrauta, Grihya, Dharma Sutras)
Jyotisha	Astronomy
Vyakaran	Grammar (e.g., Panini)
Nirukta	Etymology
Chhanda	Prosody (metrics)

- **Kalpa Sutras** explain life rituals (*Samskaras*): Upanayana, Vivaha, Antyeshti, etc.
- Not considered *Shruti*, but *Smriti* (human-authored).

VII. Other Texts

Puranas

- Meaning: 'Ancient'; compiled between 4th–6th century CE.
- Cover:
 - **Sarga** (creation), **Pratisarga**, **Manvantaras**, **Vamsha**, **Vamshanucharita**
- **18 Mahapuranas** & numerous **Upapuranas**.
- **Historically useful**: Contain data on dynasties, rivers, mountains, etc.
- **Key Puranas**: Vishnu, Bhagavata, Brahma, Matsya, Shiva, etc.
- Credited to **Vyasa**; promote **Brahmanical ideology**.

Dharmashastras

- Define **Dharma** (moral law), **Varna-Ashrama** system.
- Recognize three sources: *Shruti*, *Smriti*, *Shishtachara*.
- Two main categories:
 - **Dharmasutras** (c. 600–300 BCE)
 - **Smritis** (c. 200 BCE–900 CE)
- Social rules were **varna- and gender-specific**; **Dvija** (twice-born) vs. Shudras.
- Life divided into **4 Ashramas**:
 - Brahmacharya (student)
 - Grihastha (householder)
 - Vanaprastha (forest-dweller)
 - Sannyasa (renunciate)

Sutra Sahitya (600–300 BCE)

Historical Context:

- The period **600 BCE to 300 BCE** marked the rise of **Sutra literature**.
- It was a time of **social, political, and religious transformation** in India.
- Sutras emerged as concise, formulaic texts to **preserve complex Vedic rituals and knowledge** in a systematic form

Origin:

- Sutras **first appeared** in the **Brahmana** and **Aranyaka** texts.
- “Sutra” means **‘thread’** – indicating a thread of concise instructions.

Types of Sutras and Their Focus:

Sutra	Description
Kalpa Sutras	Contain systematic guidelines for sacrificial practices and rituals.
Shrauta Sutras	Explain the performance of Vedic (Shrauta) sacrifices , especially large public rituals.
Sulva Sutras	Deal with geometry and mathematics used in altar construction.
Grihya Sutras	Outline rules for domestic rites (marriage, naming, upanayana, etc.).
Dharma Sutras	Discuss customs, social duties, law, and ethics ; precursor to Smriti texts.

Early Vedic Period

Rig Vedic Period (1500–1000 BCE)

The **Rig Vedic Period**, also known as the **Early Vedic Period**, spans roughly from **1500 BCE to 1000 BCE**. It derives its name from the **Rigveda**, the earliest and most significant of the four Vedas, composed in this period. This era marks the **formative phase of Vedic civilization** and lays the cultural, linguistic, and spiritual foundation of later Indian society.

Sources of Knowledge

1. Literary Sources:

- The **Rigveda** is the **earliest known Indo-Aryan text**, consisting of **1,028 hymns** arranged into **10 Mandalas**.
- **Mandalas II to VII** are considered the oldest, representing the **core phase** of Early Vedic thought and life.
- Other Vedas—**Samaveda, Yajurveda, and Atharvaveda**—are of later origin.

2. Archaeological Sources:

- Excavations in **Punjab, western Uttar Pradesh, and northern Rajasthan** have uncovered **post-Harappan Chalcolithic sites** along the Indus and Ghaggar rivers.
- These sites offer limited material evidence but **corroborate literary descriptions** of settlements, cattle rearing, and rural life.

Cultural Affinities

The Rig Vedic Aryans show significant cultural parallels with:

- The **Andronovo culture** (Central Asia), particularly in the use of **horse-drawn chariots**.
- The **Mittani kingdom** of West Asia and early **Iranians**, sharing similar linguistic and religious traits.

Geographical Extent:

- The earliest Aryans inhabited **eastern Afghanistan, North-West Frontier Province, Punjab, and western Uttar Pradesh.**
- Region was known as **Sapta Sindhava** (Land of Seven Rivers).

Major Rivers Mentioned in Rig Veda:

<i>Ancient Name</i>	<i>Modern Equivalent</i>
<i>Sindhu</i>	Indus
<i>Vitasta</i>	Jhelum
<i>Askini</i>	Chenab
<i>Purushni</i>	Ravi

<i>Vipasa</i>	Beas
<i>Sutudri</i>	Sutlej
<i>Saraswati</i>	Ghaggar-Hakra
<i>Kubha</i>	Kabul
<i>Gomati</i>	Gomal
<i>Sadanira</i>	Gandak

- Saraswati** was glorified as *Naditama* (best river).
- Sindhu (Indus)**: Considered the river *par excellence*.
- Ganga and Yamuna**: Mentioned rarely, indicating limited eastern expansion.

Other Features:

- The term "**Samudra**" appears in Rig Veda but usually refers to inland water bodies rather than the sea.
- The geography described shows strong cultural ties with regions west of the Indian subcontinent, including **Afghanistan** (e.g., Harakhwati = Helmand = Saraswati).

Political Life of the Early Vedic Age

Salient Features of Rig Vedic Polity:

- Kinship-based, not territory-based political organization.
- Polity was **monarchical** but **non-despotic**.
- Emphasis on **community involvement** in governance.
- Pastoral and tribal character with **military and ritualistic governance**.
- Tribal assemblies played a key role in administration and leadership selection.

Basic Political Units:

Unit	Meaning	Head/Title
Kula	Family	Kulapa
Grama	Village (group of families)	Gramani
Vis	Clan or community (group of Gramas)	Vishpati
Jana	Tribe (largest social unit)	Gopa / Gopati
Rashtra	Territory of the tribe	Rajan

Rajan (Tribal Chief / King):

- The central figure of tribal administration.
- Duties:
 - Protection of tribe and livestock.
 - Leading in warfare and religious rituals.
- Initially elected by assemblies; later, the post became hereditary.
- Did not hold absolute power—his authority was checked by assemblies.
- Received **Bali**, voluntary contributions (not formal tax).

Military System:

- No standing army.
- War-time militia formed from able-bodied tribal members.
- Military groups: **Vrata**, **Gana**, **Gramas**, **Sardha**.
- **Senani**: Military commander.

Tribal Assemblies:

Assembly	Function
Sabha	Council of elders; judicial and deliberative in nature
Samiti	Popular tribal assembly; involved in decisions on war, religion, and king
Vidhatha	Oldest assembly; performed military, social, and religious functions
Gana	Assembly of armed men
Parishad	Later advisory body

- **Sabha and Samiti**: Frequently mentioned in Rig Veda and crucial for early democratic elements in polity.

Important Functionaries:

Functionary	Role
Purohita	Royal priest; conducted yajnas and influenced policy
Senani	Head of the militia
Vrajapati	Officer over pasture lands; led Kulapas and Gramanis into battle
Gramani	Head of village; also took military roles over time

- **Famous Priests:**
 - **Vishvamitra** – Composer of the *Gayatri Mantra*.
 - **Vasishtha** – Prominent Vedic priest.

Law and Order:

- No formal judicial system.
- Common crimes: Theft, especially cattle raiding.
- **Spies** were used to monitor antisocial activities and maintain order.

Early (Rig) Vedic Society (c. 1500–1000 BCE)**1. Social Structure**

- **Tribal society** based on **kinship** (not territory).
- The basic unit: **Kula** (family); Head: **Kulapa**.
- Larger groupings:
 - **Griha** → **Vis** (clan) → **Jana** (tribe).
 - Tribe chief: **Rajan** (also called **Gopati/Gopa**).
- Society was largely **egalitarian** but slowly developing **social stratification**.
- No concept of **janapada** or permanent **territorial state**.

2. Varna System (Emerging Phase)

- **Varna** = **colour**, used to distinguish **Arya** (fair-skinned) vs. **Dasa/Dasyu** (dark-skinned, non-Aryan).
- Only the **Purusha Sukta** (10th Mandala, late Rigveda) mentions:
 - **Brahmana** (priests)
 - **Kshatriya** (warriors)
 - **Vaishya** (commoners)
 - **Shudra** (servants)

- Varna distinctions were **not rigid**; society allowed **mobility**.
- Occupation not based on **birth** (e.g., “I am a poet, my father a physician...” – Rigveda).

3. Position of Women

- Women had **intellectual and spiritual freedom**.
 - Composed hymns: **Lopamudra, Apala, Ghosha, Viswavara**.
 - Attended **Vidatha**, assemblies, and sacrifices.
- Practices:
 - **Levirate** and **widow remarriage** present.
 - **Child marriage, sati, and purdah** absent.
 - **Marriage age**: ~16–17 years.
- **Marriage forms**: Predominantly **monogamy**; occasional **polygamy/polyandry**.

4. Social Practices and Culture

- **No formal caste system**, but social distinctions began based on **labour** and **war spoils**.
- Slavery existed (especially **female slaves**) given as **gifts** to priests.
- Lifestyle: **Semi-nomadic**, pastoral-agrarian, **joint families, patrilineal descent**.
- **Dasyus/Panis**: Non-Aryan enemies; known for **cattle theft**.
- Warfare: Frequent inter-tribal and Aryan vs. non-Aryan conflicts.
 - Famous battle: **Dasharajna (Battle of Ten Kings)** – Sudas (Bharata tribe) vs. ten tribes.

Early (Rig) Vedic Economy

1. Pastoral Base

- **Cattle (gau)** was the main form of **wealth**.
 - Terms: **Gomat** (rich in cattle), **Gavishthi** (war for cattle).
 - **Bali** (voluntary offering), not regular tax.
- **Cow = unit of value** in **barter trade**.
- Cattle used in **gift exchanges (prestations)**, sacrifices, and redistribution.

2. Agriculture

- Secondary to pastoralism, but **shifting cultivation** practiced.

- Crop: Primarily **Yava (barley)**.
- Agricultural deities:
 - **Indra** – *Urvarajit* (lord of fertile land).
 - **Kshetrapati** – guardian of fields.
- Tools: **Wooden plough** (phala, langala, sira); no iron yet (only copper).

3. Crafts and Artisans

- Known professions: **Carpenters, chariot-makers, potters, tanners, weavers, leather-workers**.
 - **Rathakara (chariot maker)** held high status.
- Metallurgy: Knowledge of **copper, bronze**; limited iron use.

4. Trade and Exchange

- **Barter system** was primary.
- Early form of currency: **Nishka** (gold coin) – used in **larger transactions**.
- Limited evidence of long-distance trade.
- Land was **not privately owned** – held by the **clan**.

5. Leisure and Consumption

- Common foods: **Barley, wheat, dairy products (milk, curd, ghee), fruits, vegetables**.
- **Clothing**: Made from **cotton and wool**.
- **Ornaments and decorations** worn by both genders.
- **Pastimes**: Chariot-racing, **dice games**, singing, dancing.

Keywords :

Term	Meaning / Description
Gavishthi	War or expedition for cattle (symbol of wealth)
Nishka	Gold ornament/coin used in large barter transactions

Vis, Jana, Griha	Social units: Clan (Vis), Tribe (Jana), Household (Griha)
Gopati	Title of king meaning "protector of cows"
Dasyus / Panis	Non-Aryan enemies, often cattle thieves
Purusha Sukta	Hymn in 10th Mandala of Rigveda describing varna origin

Prestations	Voluntary group-level gift exchange (not taxation)
Rathakara	Chariot maker; held a high status among artisans

Urvarajit	Epithet of Indra, "lord of fertile lands"
Kshetrapati	Guardian deity of agricultural fields

Rig Vedic Religion

- **Nature of Religion:**
 - Naturalistic polytheism or primitive animism.
 - Natural forces (earth, sky, wind, thunder, rain, fire) personified and worshipped.
 - Deities had **human or animal traits** and were considered **living beings**.
 - Religion was **ritual-centric** rather than spiritual or philosophical.
- **Core Religious Practices:**
 - **Yajnas (sacrifices)** were the main form of worship—performed in **open air**, not temples.
 - **Recitation of hymns (richas)** and **offerings (like barley, vegetables, milk)** were made.
 - **Animal sacrifice** was prevalent (excluding cows, which were "**Aghnya**" – **not to be killed**).
 - No idol worship or permanent places of worship.
- **Purpose of Worship:**
 - Pragmatic in nature – aimed at **material well-being**, not moksha or spiritual liberation.
 - People prayed for **praja** (children), **pashu** (cattle), health, wealth, rain, and victory.
- **Theological Concepts:**
 - **Henotheism (Kathenotheism)**: The god being praised in a hymn is treated as **supreme**, though many are acknowledged.
 - **No concept of karma or rebirth** yet in this phase.

Key Deities of Rig Vedic Pantheon

Deity	Domain / Significance	Notes
Indra	God of Thunder, Rain, War	- Most important deity (250 hymns) - Titles: <i>Purandara</i> (fort-destroyer), <i>Vritrahan</i> (slayer of demon Vritra), <i>Maghavan</i> (generous) - Hero of Aryan-Dasyu battles
Agni	God of Fire	- 2nd most important (200 hymns) - Intermediary between gods and humans - Associated with sacrifice and domestic rituals
Varuna	God of Cosmic Order (<i>Rita</i>)	- Enforcer of moral and cosmic law - Ethically supreme - Associated with water and sky
Soma	God of Intoxicating Drink & Plants	- Soma juice used in rituals - Entire Mandala 9 is dedicated to Soma - Soma plant believed to come from Mount Munjavat (Himalayas)
Rudra	God of Healing & Destruction	- Archer god, bringer of diseases - Lived in mountains; precursor to Shiva (Protosiva) - Guardian of herbs
Yama	God of Death	- First mortal to die; ruler of ancestors
Pushan	God of Travel & Herdsmen	- Protector of cattle and journeys - Transitions day and night
Vayu	God of Wind	- Drives Indra's chariot
Surya	Sun God	- Dispels darkness, linked to Dyaus (sky father)
Savitri	Solar deity	- Associated with Gayatri Mantra (Mandala 3)
Usha	Goddess of Dawn	- 300 hymns dedicated - Herald of light and activity
Aditi	Mother of Gods	- Symbol of eternity and protection from evil
Prithvi	Earth Goddess	- Earth personified as divine mother
Vishnu	Solar deity	- Benevolent, minor role in Rig Veda
Ashvins	Twin Gods of Health & Fertility	- Associated with medicine and healing
Maruts	Storm Deities	- Sons of Rudra, personify winds and storms

Priestly and Administrative Officials (Ratnins)

Title	Role / Description
Purohita	Chief Priest (also called <i>Rastragopa</i>)
Senani	Commander-in-Chief
Vrajapati	Officer of Pasture Lands

Jivagribha	Police Officer
Spasas / Dutas	Spies or Messengers
Gramani	Village Head
Kulapati	Head of the Family
Madhyamasi	Dispute Mediator
Bhagadugha	Tax Collector
Sangrihitri	Treasurer
Mahishi	Chief Queen
Suta	Royal Charioteer
Govinartana	Keeper of Forests and Games
Palagala	Messenger
Kshatri	Chamberlain
Akshavapa	Accountant
Sthapati	Chief Justice
Takshan	Carpenter

Conflict with Non-Aryans (Dasyus)

- **Dasyus / Panis:** Indigenous people of India (non-Aryans), often portrayed as enemies or demons in Rigveda.
- **Trasadasyu:** Aryan chief who subdued Dasyus.
- **Divodasa:** King of Bharatas who defeated *Sambara* (a Dasyu).
- **Dasa vs. Dasyu:** Dasas sometimes shown sympathetically; Dasyus depicted as evil, opposed to yajnas.
- **Term "Dasyuhatya":** "Slaughter of Dasyus" frequently used in Rigvedic hymns.

Battle of Ten Kings (Dasarajna Yuddha)

- **Fought between:**
 - **Bharatas** (led by King Sudas)
 - **Confederacy of 10 tribes:**
 - **Aryan Tribes:** Puru, Yadu, Turvasha, Anu, Druhyu
 - **Non-Aryan Tribes:** Alina, Paktha, Bhalanas, Shiva, Vishanin
- **Location:** Banks of River Parushni (Ravi)
- **Outcome:** Victory of Bharatas – strengthened early Vedic polity.

Key Features Summary Table

Aspect	Feature
Worship Method	Yajnas, hymns, no idols or temples
Main Deities	Indra, Agni, Varuna, Soma, Rudra, etc.
Key Concept	Henotheism, Rita (cosmic order)
Animal Sacrifice	Practiced (cow excluded – aghnya)
Priests' Role	Central in conducting yajnas
Purpose of Worship	Material needs: cattle, children, victory
Social Structure	Patriarchal; male gods dominant
Nature of Religion	Polytheistic, animistic, naturalistic

Later Vedic Age (1000–600 BCE)

The **Later Vedic Age** began around **1000 BCE** and lasted till **600 BCE**. It marked a major shift in Vedic life — from simple tribal living to more organized kingdoms and settled agriculture.

- Early Vedic Aryans lived in **Punjab and north-west India**.
- Later, they moved eastward to the **Ganga-Yamuna Doab** region — mainly in **Western Uttar Pradesh, Haryana**, and parts of **Rajasthan**.
- The **Kuru–Panchala region** became the new cultural and political center.

Use of Iron

- **Iron** (called *Shyama* or *Krishna ayas*) was first used around **1000 BCE**.
- Iron tools helped in clearing forests and made agriculture easier.
- Weapons like **arrowheads and spearheads** became common by **800 BCE**.

Settled Life & Towns

- With agriculture and crafts, people began to live in **permanent settlements**.
- The word '**Nagara**' (**town**) appears in texts, showing the **early signs of urban life**.

Wars for Land

- Unlike earlier times, wars were now fought for **land and territory**, not just for cattle.
- This led to the **formation of stronger kingdoms**.

Sources of the Later Vedic Period

- **Literary Sources:**
 - Later books of the **Rigveda** (especially Mandala X).
 - The **Samaveda**, **Yajurveda**, and **Atharvaveda** belong to this period.
- **Archaeological Sources:**
 - Excavations in **Western UP, Haryana, and Rajasthan**.
 - Discovery of **iron tools, pottery (PGW)**, and village remains.

Geography and Territorial Expansion

Initial Settlement

- Aryans initially settled between **Rivers Saraswati and Drishadvati**.
- Gradually expanded into the **Ganga–Yamuna Doab** region.
- The region of **Kuru–Panchala** (in present-day **Western Uttar Pradesh** and **Delhi**) became the **core Vedic area**.

Major Tribes and Territories

- **Kurus:** Occupied **Delhi and Upper Doab** (Kurukshetra region).
- **Panchalas:** Occupied the **Middle Doab**.
- The Kurus and Panchalas later **merged**, forming a powerful kingdom with **Hastinapur** (Meerut district, U.P.) as capital.

Eastern Expansion

- The **Satapatha Brahmana** describes **King Videgha Madhava's** eastward journey across **River Gandak**, aided by **Agni** (fire god).
- This reflects **Aryan movement toward eastern Gangetic plains**.

Transition to Janapadas

- Earlier tribal regions (**Janas**) evolved into **territorial units (Janapadas)**.
- Later Vedic texts refer to '**Rashtra**', marking a shift from tribal identity to defined **political territories**.

Political Life and Administration

Decline of Assemblies

- **Popular assemblies** like **Vidatha** disappeared.

- **Sabha** and **Samiti** still existed but lost democratic character:
 - Dominated by **nobles and Brahmanas**.
 - **Women were no longer allowed** to participate.

Rise of Monarchy

- Kingship became **more powerful and hereditary**.
- **Traces of election** of kings still existed but rare.
- The king's position was strengthened by **rituals** and **priestly support**.

Royal Titles

Kings assumed **grand titles** to assert authority:

Title	Meaning
Rajavisvajanan	King of all people
Ahlabhuvanapathi	Lord of the earth
Ekrat	Sole ruler
Samrat	Universal emperor

Royal Rituals

To gain legitimacy and demonstrate supremacy, kings performed:

Ritual	Purpose
Rajasuya Yajna	Royal consecration
Ashvamedha Yajna	Horse sacrifice to claim sovereignty
Vajapeya Yajna	Chariot race to show dominance over kinsmen

These **ceremonies** elevated the king's **political and religious prestige**.

Administration

- Officers included:
 - **Purohita** (chief priest)
 - **Senani** (military commander)
 - **Gramani** (village headman)
 - **Sangrahitri** (collector of tributes/taxes)
- **Tributes and taxes** became common, indicating early **state revenue system**.

Military System

- No **standing army**.
- **Tribal militias** were mobilized during war.

Later Vedic Economy

1. Agriculture

- Chief occupation and mainstay of the economy.
- **Use of iron tools** (Krishna/Shyama Ayas) allowed forest clearance and expansion of agriculture.
- **Ploughing (Langala)** became prominent; oxen used for ploughing.
- Rice (**Vrihi**) and wheat (Godhuma) became staple crops; barley continued.
- **Shatapatha Brahmana** and King Janaka refer to ploughing rituals.
- Use of **manure** and **cooked rice as ritual offering** mentioned.
- Cultivation was often mixed with **cattle herding** (mixed farming).
- Land still **communal** but with private claims — household head called **Grahapati**.

2. Crafts and Industries

- Rise in **occupational specialization**: metalwork, carpentry, pottery, leatherwork.
- High status of **Rathakaras** (chariot makers); eligible for Upanayana.
- Use of **multiple metals**: iron, copper, bronze, silver, tin, lead, and gold.
- **Glass manufacturing** known.
- Early signs of **industrial organization**: merchant guilds (Shrenis/Shresthins).

3. Pottery

- Four types known:
 - **Painted Grey Ware (PGW)** – most typical and widespread.
 - **Black and Red Ware**
 - **Black-Slipped Ware**
 - **Red Ware**
- PGW is associated with urban beginnings and iron use.

4. Trade and Commerce

- **Domestic trade** flourished; beginning of **long-distance sea trade** (mentions of sea voyages).
- **Barter** system prevalent; **Nishka** used as a standard of value (not actual currency).
- Use of **ox-drawn wagons** for transport.
- **Vaisyas** became prominent as merchants and **tribute-payers**.
- **Guilds (Ganas/Shresthins)** emerged; early form of trade organization.
- Some trade links with **Babylon and western Asia** inferred from textual references.

5. Revenue and Taxation

- Transition from voluntary **gifts (bali)** in early Vedic to **mandatory tribute/taxation**.
- Officer **Sangrahitri** responsible for collecting taxes/tributes.
- Only **Vaishyas** paid tributes — indication of social stratification.

Later Vedic Society

1. Varna System

- **Four-fold varna system** solidified: Brahmanas, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas, Shudras.
- **Social stratification** sharpened; Brahmanas gained dominance through ritualism.
- **Shudras** excluded from sacred thread ceremony (Upanayana) and Gayatri mantra recitation.
- **Aitareya Brahmana** degrades Shudras as servants, to be beaten at will.

2. Gotra System

- **Gotra** originally meant cattle-pen, later denoted **lineage from a common ancestor**.
- **Gotra exogamy** practiced (marriage outside gotra).
- Gotras named after legendary sages like Bhrigu, Kashyapa, Gautama, etc.

3. Ashrama System

- **Three ashramas** mentioned: Brahmacharya (student), Grihastha (householder), Vanaprastha (retired).
- **Sanyasa (renunciation)** not yet systematized but concept existed.

- Foundation of **varna-ashrama-dharma** society laid during this period.

4. Family and Gender Roles

- **Patriarchal joint family** emerged; 3–4 generations under one roof.
- Household led by **Grahapati**.
- Decline in women's position:
 - Exclusion from assemblies (Sabha and Samiti).
 - Rise in **child marriage** and instances of **sati**.
 - Texts portrayed women as subordinate (e.g., source of sorrow).
 - Rare women philosophers and queens partook in rituals, but exceptions.

5. Marriage Types (from Dharmashastra and Vedic texts)

Socially Accepted Marriages	Description	Socially Unaccepted Marriages	Description
Daiva	Daughter gifted to a priest during a sacrificial ceremony (dakshina).	Asura	Marriage by purchase; bride bought with wealth.
Arsha	Token bride price (usually a cow and a bull) is given.	Gandharva	Marriage by mutual consent or love, without family approval.
Brahma	Dowry-based, within same varna, performed with Vedic rituals.	Rakshasa	Marriage by abduction or capture, usually by warriors.
Prajapatya	Marriage without dowry or bride price, focused on mutual duty.	Paisacha	Marriage by seduction or rape of a sleeping/unconscious girl; condemned.

6. Caste and Mobility

- **Dvija (twice-born)** status limited to Brahmanas, Kshatriyas, and Vaishyas.
- **Chandalas** and other lower orders increasingly marginalized.
- **Social mobility** declined due to rigid **varna-based stratification**.
- Birth, not ability, began to determine status.

Later Vedic Religion

1. General Religious Outlook

- The **Later Vedic religion** was **dominated by ritualism and sacrificial cults** (Yajnas), showing a **shift from nature worship to complex rituals**.
- Under strong **Brahmanical influence**, religion became more **formal, hierarchical**, and centered around **sacrifice (yajna)** rather than **spontaneous prayers**.

2. Changes in Deities

Aspect	Early Vedic Period	Later Vedic Period
Supreme Deity	Indra (rain god), Agni (fire god)	Prajapati (creator)
New Important Gods	Rudra (god of animals), Vishnu (preserver), Pushan (protector of cattle, later associated with Shudras)	
Characteristics	Abstract powers personified	Shift to symbolic & personal deities ; signs of idolatry emerge

3. Sacrifices (Yajnas)

- Became the **central religious activity**, performed both **domestically and publicly**.
- Required **strict rituals, chants, and formulae** (mantras) administered by **Brahmana priests**.
- **Major Public Sacrifices**:
 - **Ashvamedha** – Horse sacrifice, asserted king's territorial authority.
 - **Rajasuya** – Royal consecration, asserted supremacy.
 - **Vajapeya** – Chariot race, prestige ritual for kings.

- Sacrifices led to **large-scale animal slaughter** and **destruction of cattle wealth**.

4. Priesthood and Brahmanical Supremacy

- **Brahmanas monopolized religious knowledge**, expanded rituals, and codified sacrificial texts (e.g., **Shatapatha Brahmana**).
- **Priests (yajamana)** became central to rituals, and priesthood became **hereditary**.
- **Dakshina (sacrificial fee)** included cows, gold, clothes, horses, and at times **territory**.
- The growing power and wealth of Brahmanas led to **social resentment** and **religious reaction**.

5. Reaction Against Ritualism

- Towards the **end of the Later Vedic period**, especially in regions like **Panchala** and **Videha**, a **reaction emerged** against ritual excesses and priestly control.
- This reaction laid the **philosophical foundations of Upanishadic thought**.
 - Emphasis shifted to **internal spirituality, meditation, and knowledge (jnana)**.
 - **Doctrines like Samsara, Karma, and Moksha** developed.

6. Socio-Religious Features

- **Different Varnas began to have their own deities**, reinforcing social stratification.
- **Pushan**, god of cattle, associated with **Shudras**, showing Varna-based religious identities.
- **Idolatry** begins to appear; worship of **symbols and objects** increases.

7. Important Concepts and Their Sources

Concept	Description	Source
Gotra	Lineage/Clan identity	<i>Atharva Veda</i>
Purushasukta Hymn	Origin of varnas from cosmic man	<i>Rig Veda</i> , 10th Mandala
Ashramas (Stages of Life)	Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha, Sannyasa	<i>Chhandogya & Jabala Upanishads</i>
Samsara	Transmigration of soul	<i>Brihadaranyaka Upanishad</i>

Trimurti	Creator (Brahma), Preserver (Vishnu), Destroyer (Shiva/Rudra)	<i>Maitrayani Upanishad</i>
Satyamev Jayate	"Truth alone triumphs"	<i>Mundaka Upanishad</i>
Sabha & Samiti as daughters of Prajapati	Political-religious myth	<i>Atharva Veda</i>

8. Impact of Later Vedic Religion

- **Rise of Brahmanical orthodoxy** based on **ritualism and hierarchy**.
- **Alienation of common people**, especially **Shudras and women**, from mainstream rituals.
- **Set the stage** for the **rise of heterodox religions** like **Buddhism and Jainism**, which **rejected ritualism, caste, and priestly dominance**.

9. Funeral Rites (Antyeshti)

- Became the **16th and final Sanskara**.
- Elaborate rituals for the **transmigration of soul** and **liberation (moksha)** became prominent.

Conclusion

Later Vedic religion marked a **transformation from nature worship to complex rituals** dominated by **Brahmanas**. The increasing **ritualization and stratification** of religion triggered **philosophical introspection**, paving the way for **Upanishadic thought** and the eventual rise of **reform movements** like **Buddhism and Jainism**.

Vedic age PYQ's : (without answers for practice)

1. We can know about early Vedic period from?

(UPSC 1980)

- (a) Archaeological excavations
- (b) Contemporary cultures
- (c) Rigveda
- (d) Jatak Katha

2. The philosophical systems of the Hindus were propounded and properly codified in the

(UPSC 1983)

- (a) Vedic age
- (b) Maurya age
- (c) Kanishka age
- (d) Gupta age

3. Rigveda, the oldest of the Vedas, chiefly contains

(UPSC 1984)

- (a) Collection of hymns to gods
- (b) Methods of Vedic yagnas
- (c) Early Aryan culture
- (d) Origin and works of Hindu gods

4. Match the columns:

(UPSC1985)

A Upanishads B Samaveda;
C.Rigveda: D.Atharvaveda:

- 1. World's oldest scriptures
- 2.Magical chants
- 3.Mysterious doctrine

4.Ritual

Codes: A B C D

(a) 4 3 2 1

(b) 3 4 1 2

(c) 1 2 3 4 9

(d) 4 2 1 3

5. The Arctic Home of the Vedas* was written by

(UPSC 1986)

- (a) Minoo Masani
- (b) Acharya Vinoba Bhave
- (c) S. Radhakrishnan
- (d) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

6. Arrange the following in proper sequence :

(UPSC1986)

- 1. Vinayapitaka
- 2 .Gita Govinda
- 3 .Raghuvamsha
- 4 .Atharvaveda.

The correct sequence is

(a) 3 2 1 4 (b) 4 3 2 1

(c) 4 1 3 2 (d) 2 4 3 1

7. The Vedic river Vitasta has been identified with which of the following modern river?

(GPSC 2017)

- (A) Jhelum
- (B) Ravi

- (C) Ghaggar-Hakra
(D) Sutlej
- 8. Painted grey-ware is attributed to (UPSC 1991)**
(a) Vedic period
(b) Guptas
(c) Mauryas
(d) Indus valley civilization
- 9. Dadhikara is the name of a mentioned in Rigveda. (GPSC 2019)**
(A) Land measurement
(B) Vedic rishi
(C) Divine horse
(D) Vedic Tribe
- 10. Which one of the following does not constitute part of the Veda? (UPSC 1992)**
(a) puranas
(b) Upanishad
(c) Brahmana
(d) Samhita
- 11. The term nishka, which meant an ornament in the Vedic period, was used in later times to denote a/an (UPSC 1993)**
(a) weapon
(b) agricultural implement
(c) script
(d) coin
- 12. Which one of the following usages was a post-Vedic development?**
(a) Dharma—Artha—Kama—Moksha
(b) Brahmana—Kshatriya—Vaishya—Shudra
(c) Brahmacharya—Grihastashrama—Vanaprashsa—Sanyasa
(d) Indra—Surya—Rudra—Marut
- 13. Who among the following was a Brahmadhini who composed some hymns of the Vedas? (UPSC 1995)**
(a) Lopamudra (b) Gargi (c) Leelavati (d) Savitri
- 14. The term Yavanapriya mentioned in ancient Sanskrit texts denoted (UPSC 1995)**
(a) a fine variety of Indian Muslim
(b) ivory
(c) damsels sent to the Greek court for dance performance
(d) pepper
- 15. The river most mentioned in early Vedic literature is (UPSC 1996)**
(a) Sindhu

- (b) Sutudri
- (c) Sarasvati
- (d) Ganga

16. In the context of ancient Indian society which one of the following terms does not belong to the category of the other three

(UPSC 1996)

- (a) Kula (b) Vamsa
- (c) Kosa (d) Gotra

17. The following map shows four of the sixteen Mahajanapadas that existed in ancient India

(UPSC 1997)

The places marked A, B, C and D respectively are:

- (a) Matsya, Cedi, Kosala, Anga
- (b) Surasena, Avanti, Vatsa, Magadha
- (c) Matsya, Avanti, Vatsa, Anga
- (d) Surasena, Cedi, Kosala, Magadha

18. Which one of the following was initially the most powerful city state of India in the 6th century B.C

(UPSC 1999)

- (a) Gandhar (b) Kamboj
- (c) Kashi (d) Magadh

19. The term 'Aryan' denotes:

(UPSC 1999)

- (a) an ethnic group
- (b) a nomadic people
- (c) a speech group
- (d) a superior race

20. Which one of the following dynasties was ruling over North India at the time of Alexander's invasion?

(UPSC 2000)

- (a) Nanda (b) Maurya
- (c) Sunga (d) Kanva

21. Which one of the following four Vedas contains an account of magical charms and spells?

(UPSC 2004)

- (a) Rigveda (b) Yajurveda
- (c) Atharvaveda (d) Samaveda

22. What does Baudhayan theorem (Baudhayan Sulva Sutras) relate to?

- (a) Lengths of sides of a right angled triangle

(UPSC 2008)

- (b) Calculation of the value of pi
- (c) Logarithmic calculations
- (d) Normal distribution curve

23. The "Dharma" and "Rita" depict a central idea of ancient Vedic civilization of India. In this context, consider the following statements

1. Dharma was a conception of

obligations and of the discharge of one's duties to oneself and to others.

2. Rita was the fundamental moral law governing the functioning of the universe and all it contained

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(UPSC 2011)

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

24. With reference to the scientific progress of ancient India, which of the statements given below are correct?

(UPSC 2012)

- 1. Different kinds of specialized surgical instruments were in common use by 1st century AD.
- 2. Transplant of internal organs in the human body had begun by the beginning of 3rd century AD.
- 3. The concept of sine of an angle was known in 5th century AD.

27. The "dharma" and "Rita" depict a central idea of ancient Vedic civilization of India. Consider the statements:

- 1. Dharma was a conception of obligations and discharge of one's duties

4. The concept of cyclic quadrilaterals was known in 7th century AD.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 and 4 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

25. The religion of early Vedic Aryans was primarily of

(UPSC 2012)

- (a) Bhakti
- (b) Image worship and Yajnas
- (c) worship of nature and Yajnas
- (d) worship of nature & Bhakti

26. The national motto of India, 'Satyameva Jayate' inscribed below the Emblem of India is taken from

(UPSC 2014)

- (a) Katha Upanishad
- (b) Chandogya Upanishad
- (c) Aitareya Upanishad
- (d) Mundaka Upanishad

2. Rita was the fundamental moral law governing the universe

Options:

UPSC CSE 2011

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only

- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

28. Popular governance system during Vedic period was:

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 1993

- (a) Despotism
- (b) Democratic
- (c) Republic
- (d) Hereditary Kingship

29. Match the Vedic rivers with their modern names:

List-I (Vedic Rivers): Kubha, Parushni, Sadanira, Sutudri

List-II (Modern Names): Gandak, Kabul, Ravi, Sutlej

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2012

- (a) 1-2-4-3
- (b) 2-3-1-4
- (c) 3-4-2-1
- (d) 4-1-3-2

30. Which Vedic deity is NOT mentioned in the Bogazkoi inscription?

Options:

UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006

- (a) Indra
- (b) Agni
- (c) Mitra
- (d) Varun

31. Boghazkoi is important because:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1996, BPSC (Pre) 1994

- (a) Major trade centre
- (b) Mentions Vedic deities in inscriptions
- (c) Basic script of Vedas composed here
- (d) None

32. Which inscription describes Aryan movement from Iran to India?

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2009

- (a) Mansehra
- (b) Shahabgarhi
- (c) Boghazkoi
- (d) Junagadh

33. Hub of Aryan culture during later Vedic period:

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2007

- (a) Anga, Magadh
- (b) Koshal, Videha
- (c) Kuru, Panchal
- (d) Matsya, Surasena

34. The term 'Bali' during Vedic period stood for:

Options:

UT RO/ARO (Mains) G.S. 2016

- (a) Sacrifice

- (b) Ox
- (c) Hereditary
- (d) Presents to the king

35. Ancient most musical instrument:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1999

- (a) Sitar
- (b) Tabla
- (c) Sarod
- (d) Veena (Lute)

36. King Ashwapati ruled which region during Upanishad period?

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1999

- (a) Kashi
- (b) Kaikaya
- (c) Panchal
- (d) Videha

37. Mentor teaching Veda-Vedanga for livelihood was called:

Options:

Uttarakhand UDA/LDA (Mains) 2007

- (a) Acharya
- (b) Adhwaryu
- (c) Upadhyaya
- (d) Purohita

38. Total number of Sanskaras:

Options:

MPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2015

- (a) 10

(b) 12

(c) 15

(d) 16

39. The word 'Kausheya' stands for:

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2008

- (a) Cotton
- (b) Jute
- (c) Silk
- (d) Wool

40. Measurements of sacrificial altars are given in:

Options:

UPPSC Asst. Forest Conservator Exam 2013

- (a) Shulva Sutra
- (b) Griha Sutra
- (c) Dharma Sutra
- (d) Kalpa Sutra

41. 'Rita' in Indian culture refers to:

Options:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2017

- (a) Natural laws
- (b) Cosmic laws
- (c) Human laws
- (d) Social laws

42. Correct ascending order of Rig Vedic political structure:

Options:

Manipur PSC (Pre) 2023

- (a) Grama > Kula > Vis > Rashtra > Jana
- (b) Kula > Grama > Vis > Jana > Rashtra
- (c) Rashtra > Jana > Grama > Kula > Vis
- (d) Jana > Grama > Kula > Vis > Rashtra

43. Which statements are correct?

- A. Puranas contain mythology
- B. Rig Vedic main crop was barley
- C. Rig Veda does not mention non-Aryans
- D. Kalika Purana describes Kamarupa history

Options: **Manipur PSC (Pre) 2023**

- (a) A and B
- (b) B and C
- (c) A, B, D
- (d) C and D

44. Battle of Ten Kings in Rigveda was fought on which river?

Options: **UPPSC (Pre) 2023**

- (a) Sutudri
- (b) Vipasha
- (c) Parushni
- (d) Vitasta

45. Oldest Veda:

Options: **Mizoram PSC (Pre) 2023**

- (a) Samaveda
- (b) Yajurveda
- (c) Rigveda
- (d) Atharvaveda

46. Correct statements about Rig Vedic religious beliefs:

- I. Dyaus = Greek Jupiter
- II. Prithvi = Mother of gods
- III. Agni = Mediator
- IV. Cow sacrifice practiced

Options: **APPSC (Pre) 2023**

- (a) I, II, III
- (b) II, III, IV
- (c) I, III, IV
- (d) I, II, IV

47. Correct statements about Rigveda:

- A. Aryans as cultural community
- B. Commonalities with Avesta
- C. Saraswati as 'naditarna'
- D. Dasyus kept cattle

Options: **Odisha PSC (Pre) 2023**

- (a) A, B, C
- (b) B, C, D
- (c) A, B, D
- (d) All correct

48. Veda with Shukla and Krishna divisions:

Options: **J&K PSC 2021**

- (a) Yajurveda
- (b) Samaveda
- (c) Rigveda
- (d) Atharvaveda

49. Gayatri Mantra in Rigveda is dedicated to:

Options:

Gujarat PSC Civil Pre-Paper 2021

- (a) Lakshmi
- (b) Savitri
- (c) Agni
- (d) Maruti

50. Gayatri Mantra first appears in:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2013, BPSC (Pre) 1994

- (a) Bhagavad Gita
- (b) Atharvaveda
- (c) Rigveda
- (d) Manu Smriti

51. Correct statements:

Gujarat PSC Civil Pre-Paper 2021

- I. Musical instruments mentioned in Rigveda
- II. String/wind instruments popular
- III. 'Dholsagar' mentions music

Options:

- (a) I, II, III
- (b) I and II
- (c) II and III
- (d) I and III

52. Avesta is associated with:

Options:

UP Lower (Pre) 2004

- (a) India

(b) Iran

(c) Israel

(d) Egypt

53. Ancient most Veda:

Options:

UP Lower (Pre) 2009-10

- (a) Samaveda
- (b) Yajurveda
- (c) Rigveda
- (d) Atharvaveda

54. Most ancient Veda:

Options:

Uttarakhand UDA/LDA (Pre) 2006, UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1995

- (a) Atharvaveda
- (b) Rigveda
- (c) Samaveda
- (d) Yajurveda

55. Correct statements about Rig

Vedic economy:

- I. Pastoralism-based
- II. Ploughs used
- III. Trade with West Asia

Options: Gujarat PSC Civil Pre-Paper 2021

- (a) I and III
- (b) II and III
- (c) I and II
- (d) All

56. Assemblies mentioned in Rigveda:

- I. Sabha
- II. Samiti
- III. Vidatha

Options: Gujarat PSC Civil Pre-Paper 2021

- (a) I and II
- (b) II and III
- (c) I and III
- (d) All

57. Sabha and Samiti are daughters of:

Options: Arunachal PSC (GS) 2021

- (a) Prajapati
- (b) Rudra
- (c) Agni
- (d) Indra

58. In which of the Vedas, Sabha and Samiti are called as the two daughters of Prajapati? UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st Paper 2009

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Sām Veda
- (c) Yajurveda
- (d) Atharva Veda

59. Dadhikara is the name of a _____ mentioned in Rigveda Gujarat PSC Pre-2019 Paper-I

- (a) Land measurement
- (b) Divine horse
- (c) Vedic rishi
- (d) Vedic Tribe

60. The Rig Vedic "Pani" belongs to which class of citizens?

- (a) Priests **MPPCS (Pre) 2019**
- (b) Ironsmiths
- (c) Goldsmiths
- (d) Traders

61. According to Rigveda which Aryan Chief defeated "Dasyus"?

NAGALAND NCS PRELIMS, 2018

- (a) Naradasyu
- (b) Trasadasyu
- (c) Suadasyu
- (d) Paradasyu

62. Which of the following is a Samhita of Shukla Yajurveda?

- (a) Vajasaneyi
- (b) Maitrayani **UPPCS (Pre) 2018**
- (c) Taittiriya
- (d) Kathak

63. The officer who enjoyed authority over a large pasture ground during Rigvedic period was known as?

- (a) Grāmini
- (b) Rigvedi **Himachal PSC (Pre) 2013**
- (c) Kulapas
- (d) Senani

64. With reference to difference between the culture of Rigvedic Aryans and Indus valley people, which of the following statement/s is/are correct?

1. Rigvedic Aryans used the coat of mail and helmet in warfare whereas the people of Indus valley civilization does not leave any evidence of using them.
2. Rigvedic Aryans knew gold, silver and copper whereas Indus

valley people knew only copper and iron.

3. Rigvedic Aryans had domesticated horse whereas there is no evidence of Indus valley people having been aware of this animal.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 & 3 only
(c) 1 & 3 only
(d) 1, 2 & 3 only

UPSC CSE 2017

65. The basic script of Rig-Veda was:

- (a) Dev Nāgari
(b) Kharoshthi
(c) Pali
(d) Brahmi

UPPCS (Pre) Spl G.S. 2004

66. Match the list I with list II and choose correct answer from the codes given below the list:

List I

- A. Rig-Veda
B. Yajurveda
C. Sam Veda
D. Atharva Veda

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2001

List II

1. Source of music
2. Hymn and sacrificial laws
3. Tantra-mantra and subjugation
4. Hymn and prayers

Codes:

- (a) 4 2 1 3
(b) 3 2 4 1
(c) 1 2 3 4
(d) 2 3 1 4

67. Collection of which of the following is based on Rig Veda?

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2001

- (a) Atharva Veda
(b) Sama Veda
(c) Yajurveda
(d) All of these

68. The early mention about Ayurveda (the science of life) is found in:

- (a) Aranyaka
(b) Sam Veda
(c) Yajurveda
(d) Atharva Veda

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1994

69. The religion of early Vedic Aryans was:

Options: UPSC CSE 2012

- (a) Bhakti
(b) Idol worship and Yajnas
(c) Worship of nature and Yajnas
(d) Worship of Nature and Bhakti

70. Rig-Vedic religion was:

Options: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2014

- (a) Polytheistic
(b) Monotheistic
(c) Monistic
(d) Liberterian

71. The people during Rig-Vedic period believed basically in which of the followings:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1993

- (a) Idol worship
- (b) Monotheism
- (c) Goddess worship
- (d) Sacrifices and rituals

72. The word Gotra occurs for the first time in:

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2005

- (a) Atharva Veda
- (b) Rig Veda
- (c) Sama Veda
- (d) Yajurveda

73. The maximum number of the Mantras in Rig Veda belongs to:

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2010

- (a) Agni
- (b) Varuna
- (c) Vishnu
- (d) Yama

74. Match the following:

List-I

MPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1995

- A. Atharva Veda
- B. Rig-Veda
- C. Yajurveda
- D. Sam Veda

List-II

- 1. Glory of God

- 2. Sacrificial laws
- 3. Associated with medicine
- 4. Music

Codes:

- (a) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4
- (b) A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
- (c) A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
- (d) A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

75. To whom the 9th Mandal of Rig-Veda is dedicated?

Options:

BPSC (Pre) 1995

- (a) Indra and his elephant
- (b) Heaven of Urvashi
- (c) Deities associated with medicinal plant
- (d) Soma and the Deity named on it

76. Which Mandal of Rig-Veda is fully dedicated to Soma?

Options:

BPSC (Pre) 1997-98

- (a) 7th Mandal
- (b) 8th Mandal
- (c) 9th Mandal
- (d) 10th Mandal

77. Laws related to sacrificial acts are found in:

Options:

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 1996

- (a) Rig-Veda

- (b) Sam Veda
- (c) Brahma epics
- (d) Yajurveda

78. Sabha during Vedic period was:

Options:

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 1994-95

- (a) An organization of professionals in the villages
- (b) Court of the king
- (c) Council of ministers
- (d) A national assembly of all the people of the state

79. Which one of the following four Vedas contains an account of magical charms and spells?

Options:

UPSC CSE 2004

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Yajur-Veda
- (c) Atharva-Veda
- (d) Sama-Veda

80. Purusha sukta related to Varna system is originally found in:

Options:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2014

- (a) Atharva Veda
- (b) Sam Veda
- (c) Rig-Veda
- (d) Manu Smriti

81. In which Vedic Epic the word 'Varna' is found at first?

Options: UP LOWER (Pre) 2014-15

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Atharva Veda
- (c) Sam Veda
- (d) Yajurveda

82. There are _____ verses in Rig-Veda:

Options:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2010-11

- (a) 1028
- (b) 1017
- (c) 1128
- (d) 1020

83. The epic which mention about Purusha Medha Yajna is?

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) Spl. G.S. 2008

- (a) Krishna Yajurveda
- (b) Shukla Yajurveda
- (c) Shapath Brahmana
- (d) Panchavish Brahmana

84. Which of the following is correct order of Vedic literature?

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) 1st Paper G.S., 2014

- (a) Vedic Samhitas, Brahmana, Aranyaka, Upanishads
- (b) Vedic Samhitas, Upanishads, Aranyaka, Brahmana
- (c) Vedic Samhitas, Aranyaka, Brahmana, Upanishads

(d) Vedic Samhitas, Vedanga, Aranyaka, Smritis

85. Match the list-I and list-II and choose your answer from the code given below:

List-I

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 2013

- A. Rig-Veda
- B. Sam Veda
- C. Atharva Veda
- D. Yajurveda

List-II

- I. Gopatha
- II. Shatpath
- III. Aitareya
- IV. Panchvisha

Code:

- (a) A-III, B-IV, C-I, D-II
- (b) A-IV, B-III, C-II, D-I
- (c) A-II, B-I, C-IV, D-III
- (d) A-I, B-II, C-III, D-IV

86. Gopath Brahmana is associated with:

Options: UP RO/ARO (Pre) 2014

- (a) Yajurveda
- (b) Sam Veda
- (c) Atharva Veda
- (d) Rig-Veda

87. The word Yava referred in Rig-Veda is applied for which agro product?

Options: UPPCS (Mains) Spl. G.S. 1st paper 2008

- (a) Barley
- (b) Gram
- (c) Rice
- (d) Wheat

88. Which of the following river is called as Mate-tama, Devi-tama, and Nadi-Tama in Rig-Veda?

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st Paper 2008

- (a) Indus
- (b) Saraswati
- (c) Vitasta
- (d) Yamuna

89. Which of the following rivers is called 'Naditama' in the Rigveda?

Options: Himachal PSC (Pre) 2013

- (a) Jhelum
- (b) Ravi
- (c) Beas
- (d) Saraswati

90. What is the Vedic name of the river Ravi?

Himachal PSC 2011

- (a) Purushni
- (b) Chandrabhaga
- (c) Arjikiya
- (d) Satadru

91. The famous battle of 'Ten Kings' as described in the Rigveda was fought on the bank of:

Options: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st Paper 2008, BPSC (Pre) 1997-98

- (a) Purushni
- (b) Saraswati
- (c) Vipasha
- (d) Asikni

92. Nishka during ancient India stands for:

Options: UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2005

- (a) Gold jewelry
- (b) Cows
- (c) Copper coins
- (d) Silver coins

93. The term Nishka, which meant an ornament in the Vedic period, was used in later times to denote a/an:

Options: UPSC CSE 1993

- (a) Weapon
- (b) Agricultural implement
- (c) Script
- (d) Coin

94. Who among the following was a Brahnavadini who composed some hymns of the Vedas?

Options: UPSC CSE 1995

- (a) Lopamudra
- (b) Gargi

- (c) Leelavati
- (d) Savitri

95. The famous conversation between Nachiketa and Yama is mentioned in the:

Options: UPSC CSE 1997

- (a) Chandogya Upanishad
- (b) Mundakopanishad
- (c) Kathopanishad
- (d) Kena Upanishad

96. In which Upanishad is the Yama-Nachiketa conversation on spiritual knowledge found?

Options: UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1999, UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2006

- (a) Brihadaranyaka Upanishad
- (b) Chandogya Upanishad
- (c) Kathopanishad
- (d) Kena Upanishad

97. The most mentioned river in early Vedic literature is:

Options: UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1999, UPSC CSE 1996

- (a) Indus
- (b) Sutudri
- (c) Saraswati
- (d) Ganga

98. An inscription of the 14th century B.C. which describes the Vedic Gods has been found in:

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2016

- (a) Ecbatana
- (b) Boghaz-Koi
- (c) Babylon
- (d) Bisotun

99. The ancient name Nilotpala for Mahanadi was stated in:

Options:

Chhattisgarh PCS (Pre) 2017-18

- (a) Matsya Purana
- (b) Markandeya Purana
- (c) Brahma Purana
- (d) Vayu Purana

100. Which of the following was considered a valuable asset during the Rigvedic period?

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) Re-exam. G.S. 2015

- (a) Land
- (b) Cow
- (c) Women
- (d) Water

101. Which animal was called Aghanya during the Vedic period?

Options: **UP**

UDA/LDA Spl. (Pre) 2010, UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2017

- (a) Ox
- (b) Sheep
- (c) Cow
- (d) Elephant

102. The national motto of India, 'Satyameva Jayate' inscribed below the Emblem of India, is taken from:

Options: **UPSC CSE 2014**

- (a) Katha Upanishad
- (b) Chandogya Upanishad
- (c) Aitareya Upanishad
- (d) Mundakopnishad

103. Which of the following Vedic texts talks about Salvation?

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2003

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Later Samhitas
- (c) Brahmanas
- (d) Upanishads

104. Upanishads are texts on:

Options: **UP Lower (Pre) 1998**

- (a) Religion
- (b) Yoga
- (c) Law
- (d) Philosophy

105. In which of the following Upanishads is the earliest mention of pessimism found?

Options: **UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006**

- (a) Maitrayani
- (b) Kaushitaki
- (c) Brihadaranyaka
- (d) Kena

106. Reference to which of the following rivers in the Rigveda establishes the Aryans' relation with Afghanistan?

Options: UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2010

- (a) Asikni
- (b) Parushni
- (c) Kubha, Krumu
- (d) Vipasha, Sutudri

107. Where is the location of the Vedic river Kubha?

Options: UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1999

- (a) Afghanistan
- (b) Chinese Turkistan
- (c) Kashmir
- (d) Punjab

108. Reference to which of the following rivers in the Rigveda indicates that Afghanistan was part of early Vedic territory?

Options: UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006

- (a) Asikni & Parushni
- (b) Vipasha & Sutudri
- (c) Sindhu & Vitasta
- (d) Kubha & Suvastu

109. Who among the following Vedic deities was believed to be their priest?

Options: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2013

- (a) Agni
- (b) Brihaspati
- (c) Dyaus
- (d) Indra

110. Which of the following is described as the God of War in the Rigveda?

Options: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2011

- (a) Agni
- (b) Indra
- (c) Rudra
- (d) Vishnu

111. Most of the Rigvedic hymns are devoted to:

Options: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2002

- (a) Agni
- (b) Indra
- (c) Rudra
- (d) Vishnu

112. Who among the following was the most popular God of the early Vedic Aryans?

Options: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2008

- (a) Varuna
- (b) Vishnu
- (c) Rudra
- (d) Indra

113. Which among the following Rigvedic deities was acknowledged as a guest?

Options:

Jharkhand PCS (Pre) G.S. 2008

- (a) Indra
- (b) Varuna
- (c) Agni
- (d) Soma

114. In Vedic rituals, Hota is associated with:

Options: UP RO/ARO (Mains) 2013

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Yajurveda
- (c) Samaveda
- (d) Atharvaveda

115. The term 'Aryan' denotes:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2007, UPSC CSE 1999

- (a) An ethnic group
- (b) A nomadic people
- (c) A speech group
- (d) A superior race

116. Meaning of the word Arya in classical Sanskrit?

Options: UP Lower (Pre) 1998

- (a) Believer in God
- (b) A hereditary caste
- (c) Person having faith in others' religion
- (d) A noble person

117. Name the tribe which does not belong to the Panchajana of Rigvedic Aryans?

Options: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2009

- (a) Yadu
- (b) Puru
- (c) Turvasa
- (d) Kikata

118. Who composed the Gayatri Mantra?

Options:

Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) G.S. 2006-07

- (a) Vashishtha
- (b) Vishwamitra
- (c) Indra
- (d) Parikshita

119. In the context of ancient Indian society, which one of the following terms does not belong to the category of the other three?

Options: UPSC CSE 1996

- (a) Kula
- (b) Vansha
- (c) Kosha
- (d) Gotra

120. Who among the following had not participated in the Dasharajna battle?

Options: UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006

- (a) Tritsu
- (b) Paktha

- (c) Vishanin
- (d) Gandhari

121. Choose the correct chronological order of the four Purusharthas:

Options: Uttarakhand PCS (Mains)

2010-11

- (a) Dharma-Kama-Artha-Moksha
- (b) Dharma-Artha-Kama-Moksha
- (c) Artha-Kama-Dharma-Moksha
- (d) Kama-Artha-Dharma-Moksha

122. Which Vedic text first mentioned the word 'Varna'?

Options: Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) G.S.

1st 2014-15

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Atharvaveda
- (c) Samaveda
- (d) Yajurveda

123. The basis of untouchability during the Vedic age was:

Options:

UPPSC Asst. Forest Conservator Exam 2013

- (a) Desecration
- (b) Occupation
- (c) Poverty
- (d) None of the above

124. Rig-Veda is a:

Options: UP RO/ARO (Pre) 2016

- (a) Collection of hymns
- (b) Collection of stories

- (c) Collection of words
- (d) A book of war

125. Statements about Vedic deity

Indra: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2017

1. God of thunderstorms
2. Punished sinners
3. Guardian of moral system
4. God of rain

Options:

- (a) 1 & 2 true
- (b) 1 & 3 true
- (c) 2 & 4 true
- (d) 1 & 4 true

126. War-God in Vedic Pantheon:

Options:

Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) G.S. 2016

- (a) Varuna
- (b) Indra
- (c) Mitra
- (d) Agni

127. Rigvedic tribal assembly with judicial functions:

Options: Jharkhand PSC (Pre) G.S. 2016

- (a) Sabha
- (b) Samiti
- (c) Vidatha
- (d) All

128. 'Tamso-Ma-Jyotirgamaya' belongs to:

Options:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2017

- (a) Upanishad
- (b) Chhandogya Upanishad
- (c) Puranas
- (d) Sad Darshan

129. Upanishad meaning "white horse":

Options:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2017

- (a) Kathopanishad
- (b) Chhandogya Upanishad
- (c) Shwetashwatar Upanishad
- (d) Isha Upanishad

130. Medium of trade exchange in

Vedic period: MPSC (Pre) 2023

- i. Nishka
- ii. Krishnala
- iii. Shatmana
- iv. Gana
- v. Shreni

Options:

- (a) i, ii, iii
- (b) ii, iii, iv
- (c) i, ii, iv, v
- (d) i, iii, v

131. Officer known as 'Bhagadugha' in Vedic administration:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) 2023

- (a) Chief of Forests
- (b) Revenue Collector
- (c) Messenger
- (d) Chief of Gambling Dept.

132. Bhagavad Gita is part of which Mahabharata Parva?

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) 2023

- (a) Anushasana Parva
- (b) Shanti Parva
- (c) Bhishma Parva
- (d) Drona Parva

133. Votive inscriptions refer to:

Options:

JKPSC (Pre) 2023

- (a) Records of women's miseries
- (b) Gifts to religious institutions
- (c) Royal orders
- (d) Accounts of sacrifices

134. Puranas referencing ancient

Assam:

Assam PSC (Pre) 2022

- i. Markandeya
- ii. Skanda
- iii. Naradiya
- iv. Vishnu

Options:

- (a) i & iv
- (b) Only iv
- (c) ii, iii, iv
- (d) All

135. Later Vedic religion became more:

Options: **Mizoram PSC (Pre) 2018**

- (a) Similar
- (b) Simple
- (c) Complex
- (d) Relaxed

136. Sage who Aryanized South India:

Options:

Jharkhand PSC (Pre) G.S. 2013

- (a) Vishwamitra
- (b) Agastya
- (c) Vasishta
- (d) Sambhar

137. Official NOT included in Ratnins:

Options: **UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006**

- (a) Gramani
- (b) Mahishi
- (c) Shapati
- (d) Suta

138. Epic mentioning Krishna, son of

Devaki:

Options:

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 1999-2000

- (a) Mahabharata
- (b) Chhandogya Upanishad
- (c) Ashtadhyayi
- (d) Bhagavata Purana

139. Legend of Satyakam Jabala is in:

Options:

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 2016

- (a) Chhandogya Upanishad
- (b) Jabala Upanishad
- (c) Kathopanishad
- (d) Prashnopanishad

140. Ekalavya was disciple of:

Options:

MPPSC (Pre) G.S. 1996

- (a) Bhishma
- (b) Parashuram
- (c) Balaram
- (d) Dronacharya

141. Post-Vedic development:

Options:

UPSC CSE 1994

- (a) Dharma-Artha-Kama-Moksha
- (b) Brahmana-Kshatriya-Vaishya-Shudra
- (c) Brahmacharya-Grihastha-Vanaprastha-Sanyasa
- (d) Indra-Surya-Rudra-Marut

142. Sarga, Pratisarga, Vamsa,

Manvantars, Vansanucharita indicate:

Options:

- (a) Vedas **UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2015**
- (b) Puranas
- (c) Upanishads
- (d) Sutras

143. Number of Puranas:

Options: **UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2009**

- (a) 12
- (b) 16
- (c) 18
- (d) 20

144. First law-giver of India:

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2008**

- (a) Panini
- (b) Manu
- (c) Kautilya
- (d) Kapil

Vedic age PYQ's : (with answers)

1. We can know about early Vedic period from?

(UPSC 1980)

- (a) Archaeological excavations
- (b) Contemporary cultures
- (c) Rigveda
- (d) Jatak Katha

2. The philosophical systems of the Hindus were propounded and properly codified in the

(UPSC 1983)

- (a) Vedic age
- (b) Maurya age
- (c) Kanishka age
- (d) Gupta age

3. Rigveda, the oldest of the Vedas, chiefly contains

(UPSC 1984)

- (a) Collection of hymns to gods
- (b) Methods of Vedic yagnas
- (c) Early Aryan culture
- (d) Origin and works of Hindu gods

4. Match the columns:

(UPSC 1985)

A Upanishads B Samaveda;
C. Rigveda: D. Atharvaveda:

- 1. World's oldest scriptures
- 2. Magical chants

3. Mysterious doctrine

4. Ritual

Codes: A B C D

(a) 4 3 2 1 (b) 3 4 1 2

(c) 1 2 3 4 9 (d) 4 2 1 3

5. The Arctic Home of the Vedas* was written by

(UPSC 1986)

(a) Minoo Masani

(b) Acharya Vinoba Bhave

(c) S. Radhakrishnan

(d) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

6. Arrange the following in proper sequence :

(UPSC 1986)

1. Vinayapitaka

2. Gita Govinda

3. Raghuvarsha

4. Atharvaveda.

The correct sequence is

(a) 3 2 1 4 (b) 4 3 2 1

(c) 4 1 3 2 (d) 2 4 3 1

7. The Vedic river Vitasta has been identified with which of the following modern river?

(GPSC 2017)

(A) Jhelum

(B) Ravi

(C) Ghaggar-Hakra

(D) Sutlej

8. Painted grey-ware is attributed to
(UPSC 1991)

(a) Vedic period

(b) Guptas

(c) Mauryas

(d) Indus valley civilization

9. Dadhikara is the name of a mentioned in Rigveda.

(GPSC 2019)

(A) Land measurement

(B) Vedic rishi

(C) Divine horse

(D) Vedic Tribe

10. Which one of the following does not constitute part of the Veda?

(a) puranas **(UPSC 1992)**

(b) Upanishad

(c) Brahmana

(d) Samhita

11. The term nishka, which meant an ornament in the Vedic period, was used in later times to denote a/an

(a) weapon **(UPSC 1993)**

(b) agricultural implement

(c) script

(d) coin

12. Which one of the following usages was a post-Vedic development?

(UPSC 1994)

(a) Dharma—Artha—Kama—
Moksha

- (b) Brahmana—Kshatriya—
Vaishya—Shudra
(c) Brahmacharya—
Grihastashrama—Vanaprasha—
Sanyasa
(d) Indra—Surya—Rudra—Marut

13. Who among the following was a Brahnavadini who composed some hymns of the Vedas?

(UPSC 1995)

- (a) Lopamudra (b) Gargi
(c) Leelavati (d) Savitri

14. The term Yavanapriya mentioned in ancient Sanskrit texts denoted

(UPSC 1995)

- (a) a fine variety of Indian Muslim
(b) ivory
(c) damsels sent to the Greek court for dance performance
(d) pepper

15. The river most mentioned in early Vedic literature is **(UPSC 1996)**

- (a) Sindhu
(b) Sutudri
(c) Sarasvati
(d) Ganga

16. In the context of ancient Indian society which one of the following terms does not belong to the category of the other three

(UPSC 1996)

- (a) Kula (b) Vamsa
(c) Kosa (d) Gotra

17. The following map shows four of the sixteen Mahajanapadas that existed in ancient India

(UPSC 1997)

The places marked A, B, C and D respectively are:

- (a) Matsya, Cedi, Kosala, Anga
(b) Surasena, Avanti, Vatsa, Magadha
(c) Matsya, Avanti, Vatsa, Anga
(d) Surasena, Cedi, Kosala, Magadha

18. Which one of the following was initially the most powerful city state of India in the 6th century B.C

(UPSC 1999)

- (a) Gandhar (b) Kamboj
(c) Kashi (d) Magadh

19. The term 'Aryan' denotes:

(UPSC 1999)

- (a) an ethnic group
(b) a nomadic people
(c) a speech group
(d) a superior race

20. Which one of the following dynasties was ruling over North India at the time of Alexander's invasion?

(UPSC 2000)

- (a) Nanda (b) Maurya
(c) Sunga (d) Kanva

21. Which one of the following four Vedas contains an account of magical charms and spells?

(UPSC 2004)

- (a) Rigveda (b) Yajurveda
(c) Atharvaveda (d) Samaveda

22. What does Baudhayan theorem (Baudhayan Sulva Sutras) relate to? **(UPSC 2008)**

- (a) Lengths of sides of a right angled triangle
(b) Calculation of the value of pi
(c) Logarithmic calculations
(d) Normal distribution curve

23. The "Dharma" and "Rita" depict a central idea of ancient Vedic civilization of India. In this context, consider the following statements

1. Dharma was a conception of obligations and of the discharge of one's duties to oneself and to others.

2. Rita was the fundamental moral law governing the functioning of the universe and all it contained

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(UPSC 2011)

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

24. With reference to the scientific progress of ancient India, which of the statements given below are correct?

(UPSC 2012)

1. Different kinds of specialized surgical instruments were in common use by 1st century AD.
2. Transplant of internal organs in the human body had begun by the beginning of 3rd century AD.
3. The concept of sine of an angle was known in 5th century AD.
4. The concept of cyclic quadrilaterals was known in 7th century AD.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

25. The religion of early Vedic Aryans was primarily of **(UPSC 2012)**

- (a) Bhakti
- (b) Image worship and Yajnas
- (c) worship of nature and Yajnas
- (d) worship of nature & Bhakti

26. The national motto of India, 'Satyameva Jayate' inscribed

below the Emblem of India is

27. The "dharma" and "Rita" depict a central idea of ancient Vedic civilization of India. Consider the statements:

1. Dharma was a conception of obligations and discharge of one's duties

2. Rita was the fundamental moral law governing the universe

Options:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c) Both 1 and 2

28. Popular governance system during Vedic period was:

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 1993

- (a) Despotism
- (b) Democratic
- (c) Republic

taken from

(UPSC 2014)

- (a) Katha Upanishad
- (b) Chandogya Upanishad
- (c) Aitareya Upanishad
- (d) Mundaka Upanishad

(d) Hereditary Kingship

Answer: (d) Hereditary Kingship

29. Match the Vedic rivers with their modern names:

List-I (Vedic Rivers): Kubha, Parushni, Sadanira, Sutudri

List-II (Modern Names): Gandak, Kabul, Ravi, Sutlej

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2012

- (a) 1-2-4-3
- (b) 2-3-1-4
- (c) 3-4-2-1
- (d) 4-1-3-2

Answer: (b) Kubha-Kabul, Parushni-Ravi, Sadanira-Gandak, Sutudri-Sutlej

30. Which Vedic deity is NOT mentioned in the Bogazkoi inscription?

Options:

UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006

- (a) Indra
- (b) Agni
- (c) Mitra

(d) Varun

Answer: (b) Agni

31. Boghazkoi is important because:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1996, BPSC (Pre) 1994

(a) Major trade centre

(b) Mentions Vedic deities in inscriptions

(c) Basic script of Vedas composed here

(d) None

Answer: (b) Mentions Vedic deities in inscriptions

32. Which inscription describes Aryan movement from Iran to India?

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2009

(a) Mansehra

(b) Shahabgarhi

(c) Boghazkoi

(d) Junagadh

Answer: (c) Boghazkoi

33. Hub of Aryan culture during later Vedic period:

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2007

(a) Anga, Magadh

(b) Koshal, Videha

(c) Kuru, Panchal

(d) Matsya, Surasena

Answer: (c) Kuru, Panchal

34. The term 'Bali' during Vedic period stood for:

Options:

UT RO/ARO (Mains) G.S. 2016

(a) Sacrifice

(b) Ox

(c) Hereditary

(d) Presents to the king

Answer: (d) Presents to the king

35. Ancient most musical instrument:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1999

(a) Sitar

(b) Tabla

(c) Sarod

(d) Veena (Lute)

Answer: (d) Veena

36. King Ashwapati ruled which region during Upanishad period?

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1999

(a) Kashi

(b) Kaikaya

(c) Panchal

(d) Videha

Answer: (b) Kaikaya

37. Mentor teaching Veda-Vedanga for livelihood was called:

Options:

Uttarakhand UDA/LDA (Mains) 2007

- (a) Acharya
- (b) Adhwaryu
- (c) Upadhyaya
- (d) Purohita

Answer: (c) Upadhyaya

38. Total number of Sanskaras:

Options:

MPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2015

- (a) 10
- (b) 12
- (c) 15
- (d) 16

Answer: (d) 16

39. The word 'Kausheya' stands for:

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2008

- (a) Cotton
- (b) Jute
- (c) Silk
- (d) Wool

Answer: (c) Silk

40. Measurements of sacrificial altars are given in:

Options:

UPPSC Asst. Forest Conservator Exam 2013

- (a) Shulva Sutra

(b) Griha Sutra

(c) Dharma Sutra

(d) Kalpa Sutra

Answer: (a) Shulva Sutra

41. 'Rita' in Indian culture refers to:

Options:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2017

- (a) Natural laws
- (b) Cosmic laws
- (c) Human laws
- (d) Social laws

Answer: (a) Natural laws

42. Correct ascending order of Rig Vedic political structure:

Options:

Manipur PSC (Pre) 2023

- (a) Grama > Kula > Vis > Rashtra > Jana
- (b) Kula > Grama > Vis > Jana > Rashtra
- (c) Rashtra > Jana > Grama > Kula > Vis
- (d) Jana > Grama > Kula > Vis > Rashtra

Answer: (b) Kula > Grama > Vis > Jana > Rashtra

43. Which statements are correct?

Manipur PSC (Pre) 2023

- A. Puranas contain mythology
- B. Rig Vedic main crop was barley
- C. Rig Veda does not mention non-Aryans
- D. Kalika Purana describes Kamarupa history

Options:

- (a) A and B
- (b) B and C
- (c) A, B, D
- (d) C and D

Answer: (c) A, B, D

44. Battle of Ten Kings in Rigveda was fought on which river?

Options: UPPSC (Pre) 2023

- (a) Sutudri
- (b) Vipasha
- (c) Parushni
- (d) Vitasta

Answer: (c) Parushni

45. Oldest Veda:

Options: Mizoram PSC (Pre) 2023

- (a) Samaveda
- (b) Yajurveda
- (c) Rigveda
- (d) Atharvaveda

Answer: (c) Rigveda

46. Correct statements about Rig Vedic religious beliefs: APPSC (Pre) 2023

- I. Dyaus = Greek Jupiter
- II. Prithvi = Mother of gods
- III. Agni = Mediator
- IV. Cow sacrifice practiced

Options:

- (a) I, II, III
- (b) II, III, IV

(c) I, III, IV

(d) I, II, IV

Answer: (c) I, III, IV

47. Correct statements about Rigveda:

Odisha PSC (Pre) 2023

- A. Aryans as cultural community
- B. Commonalities with Avesta
- C. Saraswati as 'naditarna'
- D. Dasyus kept cattle

Options:

- (a) A, B, C
- (b) B, C, D
- (c) A, B, D
- (d) All correct

Answer: (d) All correct

48. Veda with Shukla and Krishna divisions:

Options: J&K PSC 2021

- (a) Yajurveda
- (b) Samaveda
- (c) Rigveda
- (d) Atharvaveda

Answer: (a) Yajurveda

49. Gayatri Mantra in Rigveda is dedicated to:

Options:

Gujarat PSC Civil Pre-Paper 2021

- (a) Lakshmi
- (b) Savitri
- (c) Agni

(d) Maruti

Answer: (b) Savitri

50. Gayatri Mantra first appears in:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2013, BPSC (Pre) 1994

(a) Bhagavad Gita

(b) Atharvaveda

(c) Rigveda

(d) Manu Smriti

Answer: (c) Rigveda

51. Correct statements:

Gujarat PSC Civil Pre-Paper 2021

I. Musical instruments mentioned in Rigveda

II. String/wind instruments popular

III. 'Dholsagar' mentions music

Options:

(a) I, II, III

(b) I and II

(c) II and III

(d) I and III

Answer: (b) I and II

52. Avesta is associated with:

Options: UP Lower (Pre) 2004

(a) India

(b) Iran

(c) Israel

(d) Egypt

Answer: (b) Iran

53. Ancient most Veda:

Options: UP Lower (Pre) 2009-10

(a) Samaveda

(b) Yajurveda

(c) Rigveda

(d) Atharvaveda

Answer: (c) Rigveda

54. Most ancient Veda:

Options:

Uttarakhand UDA/LDA (Pre) 2006, UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1995

(a) Atharvaveda

(b) Rigveda

(c) Samaveda

(d) Yajurveda

Answer: (b) Rigveda

55. Correct statements about Rig

Vedic economy: Gujarat PSC Civil Pre-Paper 2021

I. Pastoralism-based

II. Ploughs used

III. Trade with West Asia

Options:

(a) I and III

(b) II and III

(c) I and II

(d) All

Answer: (d) All

56. Assemblies mentioned in Rigveda:

Gujarat PSC Civil Pre-Paper 2021

- I. Sabha
- II. Samiti
- III. Vidatha

Options:

- (a) I and II
- (b) II and III
- (c) I and III
- (d) All

Answer: (d) All

57. Sabha and Samiti are daughters of:

Options: Arunachal PSC (GS) 2021

- (a) Prajapati
- (b) Rudra
- (c) Agni
- (d) Indra

Answer: (a) Prajapati

58. In which of the Vedas, Sabha and Samiti are called as the two daughters of Prajapati?

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st Paper 2009

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Sām Veda
- (c) Yajurveda
- (d) Atharva Veda

Answer : (d) Atharva Veda

59. Dadhikara is the name of a _____ mentioned in Rigveda

Gujarat PSC Pre-2019 Paper-I

- (a) Land measurement

- (b) Divine horse
- (c) Vedic rishi
- (d) Vedic Tribe

Answer : (b) Divine horse

60. The Rig Vedic "Pani" belongs to which class of citizens?

(a) Priests MPPCS (Pre) 2019

- (b) Ironsmiths
- (c) Goldsmiths
- (d) Traders

Answer : (d) Traders

61. According to Rigveda which Aryan Chief defeated "Dasyus"? NAGALAND NCS PRELIMS, 2018

- (a) Naradasyu
- (b) Trasadasyu
- (c) Suadasyu
- (d) Paradasyu

Answer : (b) Trasadasyu

62. Which of the following is a Samhita of Shukla Yajurveda?

(a) Vajasaneyi UPPCS (Pre) 2018

- (b) Maitrayani
- (c) Taittiriya
- (d) Kathak

Answer : (a) Vajasaneyi

63. The officer who enjoyed authority over a large pasture ground during Rigvedic period was known as?

(a) Grāmini Himachal PSC (Pre) 2013

- (b) Rigvedi
- (c) Kulapas
- (d) Senani

Answer : (b) Rigvedi

64. With reference to difference between the culture of Rigvedic Aryans and Indus valley people, which of the following statement/s is/are correct?

1. Rigvedic Aryans used the coat of mail and helmet in warfare whereas the people of Indus valley civilization does not leave any evidence of using them.
2. Rigvedic Aryans knew gold, silver and copper whereas Indus valley people knew only copper and iron.
3. Rigvedic Aryans had domesticated horse whereas there is no evidence of Indus valley people having been aware of this animal.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 & 3 only **UPSC CSE 1st 2017**
- (c) 1 & 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 & 3 only

Answer : (c) 1 & 3 only

65. The basic script of Rig-Veda was:
UPPCS (Pre) Spl G.S. 2004

- (a) Dev Nāgari
- (b) Kharoshthi
- (c) Pali
- (d) Brahmi

Answer : (a) Dev Nāgari

66. Match the list I with list II and choose correct answer from the codes given below the list:

List I

- A. Rig-Veda
- B. Yajurveda
- C. Sam Veda
- D. Atharva Veda

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2001

List II

1. Source of music
2. Hymn and sacrificial laws
3. Tantra-mantra and subjugation
4. Hymn and prayers

Codes:

- (a) 4 2 1 3
- (b) 3 2 4 1
- (c) 1 2 3 4
- (d) 2 3 1 4

Answer : (a) 4 2 1 3

67. Collection of which of the following is based on Rig Veda?
UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2001

- (a) Atharva Veda
- (b) Sama Veda
- (c) Yajurveda
- (d) All of these

Answer ; (b) Sama Veda

68. The early mention about Ayurveda (the science of life) is found in:

Options: UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1994

- (a) Aranyaka
- (b) Sam Veda
- (c) Yajurveda

(d) Atharva Veda

Answer: (d) Atharva Veda

69. The religion of early Vedic Aryans was:

Options: **UPSC CSE 2012**

- (a) Bhakti
- (b) Idol worship and Yajnas
- (c) Worship of nature and Yajnas
- (d) Worship of Nature and Bhakti

Answer: (c) Worship of nature and Yajnas

70. Rig-Vedic religion was:

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2014**

- (a) Polytheistic
- (b) Monotheistic
- (c) Monistic
- (d) Liberterian

Answer: (a) Polytheistic

71. The people during Rig-Vedic period believed basically in which of the followings:

Options: **UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1993**

- (a) Idol worship
- (b) Monotheism
- (c) Goddess worship
- (d) Sacrifices and rituals

Answer: (d) Sacrifices and rituals

72. The word Gotra occurs for the first time in:

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2005**

(a) Atharva Veda

(b) Rig Veda

(c) Sama Veda

(d) Yajurveda

Answer: (b) Rig Veda

73. The maximum number of the Mantras in Rig Veda belongs to:

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2010**

- (a) Agni
- (b) Varuna
- (c) Vishnu
- (d) Yama

Answer: (a) Agni

74. Match the following:

List-I **MPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1995**

- A. Atharva Veda
- B. Rig-Veda
- C. Yajurveda
- D. Sam Veda

List-II

- 5. Glory of God
- 6. Sacrificial laws
- 7. Associated with medicine
- 8. Music

Codes:

- (a) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4
- (b) A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
- (c) A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1

(d) A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

Answer: (a) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

75. To whom the 9th Mandal of Rig-Veda is dedicated?

Options: **BPSC (Pre) 1995**

- (a) Indra and his elephant
- (b) Heaven of Urvashi
- (c) Deities associated with medicinal plant
- (d) Soma and the Deity named on it

Answer: (d) Soma and the Deity named on it

76. Which Mandal of Rig-Veda is fully dedicated to Soma?

Options: **BPSC (Pre) 1997-98**

- (a) 7th Mandal
- (b) 8th Mandal
- (c) 9th Mandal
- (d) 10th Mandal

Answer: (c) 9th Mandal

77. Laws related to sacrificial acts are found in:

Options: **RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 1996**

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Sam Veda
- (c) Brahma epics
- (d) Yajurveda

Answer: (d) Yajurveda

78. Sabha during Vedic period was:

Options: **RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 1994-95**

(a) An organization of professionals in the villages

- (b) Court of the king
- (c) Council of ministers
- (d) A national assembly of all the people of the state

Answer: (c) Council of ministers

79. Which one of the following four Vedas contains an account of magical charms and spells?

Options:

UPSC CSE 2004, Jharkhand PCS (Pre) 2010

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Yajur-Veda
- (c) Atharva-Veda
- (d) Sama-Veda

Answer: (c) Atharva-Veda

80. Purusha sukta related to Varna system is originally found in:

Options:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2014

- (a) Atharva Veda
- (b) Sam Veda
- (c) Rig-Veda
- (d) Manu Smriti

Answer: (c) Rig-Veda

81. In which Vedic Epic the word 'Varna' is found at first?

Options: **UP LOWER (Pre) 2014-15**

- (a) Rig-Veda

(b) Atharva Veda

(c) Sam Veda

(d) Yajurveda

Answer: (a) Rig-Veda

82. There are _____ verses in Rig-Veda:

Options:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2010-11

(a) 1028

(b) 1017

(c) 1128

(d) 1020

Answer: (a) 1028

83. The epic which mention about Purusha Medha Yajna is?

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) Spl. G.S. 2008

(a) Krishna Yajurveda

(b) Shukla Yajurveda

(c) Shapath Brahmana

(d) Panchavish Brahmana

Answer: (c) Shapath Brahmana

84. Which of the following is correct order of Vedic literature?

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) 1st Paper G.S., 2014

(a) Vedic Samhitas, Brahmana, Aranyaka, Upanishads

(b) Vedic Samhitas, Upanishads, Aranyaka, Brahmana

(c) Vedic Samhitas, Aranyaka,

Brahmana, Upanishads

(d) Vedic Samhitas, Vedanga,

Aranyaka, Smritis

Answer: (a) Vedic Samhitas, Brahmana, Aranyaka, Upanishads

85. Match the list-I and list-II and choose your answer from the code given below:

List-I

RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 2013

A. Rig-Veda

B. Sam Veda

C. Atharva Veda

D. Yajurveda

List-II

I. Gopatha

II. Shatpath

III. Aitareya

IV. Panchvisha

Code:

(a) A-III, B-IV, C-I, D-II

(b) A-IV, B-III, C-II, D-I

(c) A-II, B-I, C-IV, D-III

(d) A-I, B-II, C-III, D-IV

Answer: (a) A-III, B-IV, C-I, D-II

86. Gopath Brahmana is associated with:

Options: UP RO/ARO (Pre) 2014

(a) Yajurveda

(b) Sam Veda

- (c) Atharva Veda
- (d) Rig-Veda

Answer: (c) Atharva Veda

87. The word Yava referred in Rig-Veda is applied for which agro product?

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) Spl. G.S. 1st paper 2008**

- (a) Barley
- (b) Gram
- (c) Rice
- (d) Wheat

Answer: (a) Barley

88. Which of the following river is called as Mate-tama, Devi-tama, and Nadi-Tama in Rig-Veda?

Options:

UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st Paper 2008

- (a) Indus
- (b) Saraswati
- (c) Vitasta
- (d) Yamuna

Answer: (b) Saraswati

89. Which of the following rivers is called 'Naditama' in the Rigveda?

Options: **Himachal PSC (Pre) 2013**

- (a) Jhelum
- (b) Ravi
- (c) Beas
- (d) Saraswati

Answer: (d) Saraswati

90. What is the Vedic name of the river Ravi?

- (a) Purushni

Himachal PSC 2011

- (b) Chandrabhaga
- (c) Arjikiya
- (d) Satadru

Answer: (a) Purushni

91. The famous battle of 'Ten Kings' as described in the Rigveda was fought on the bank of:

Options:

UPPCS

(Mains) G.S. 1st Paper 2008, BPSC (Pre) 1997-98

- (a) Purushni
- (b) Saraswati
- (c) Vipasha
- (d) Asikni

Answer: (a) Purushni

92. Nishka during ancient India stands for:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2005

- (a) Gold jewelry
- (b) Cows
- (c) Copper coins
- (d) Silver coins

Answer: (a) Gold jewelry

93. The term Nishka, which meant an ornament in the Vedic period, was used in later times to denote a/an:

Options:

UPSC CSE 1993, UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2007

- (a) Weapon
- (b) Agricultural implement
- (c) Script
- (d) Coin

Answer: (d) Coin

94. Who among the following was a Brahnavadini who composed some hymns of the Vedas?

Options:

UPSC CSE 1995

- (a) Lopamudra
- (b) Gargi
- (c) Leelavati
- (d) Savitri

Answer: (a) Lopamudra

95. The famous conversation between Nachiketa and Yama is mentioned in the:

Options:

UPSC CSE 1997

- (a) Chandogya Upanishad
- (b) Mundakopanishad
- (c) Kathopanishad
- (d) Kena Upanishad

Answer: (c) Kathopanishad

96. In which Upanishad is the Yama-Nachiketa conversation on spiritual knowledge found?

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1999

- (a) Brihadaranyaka Upanishad
- (b) Chandogya Upanishad
- (c) Kathopanishad
- (d) Kena Upanishad

Answer: (c) Kathopanishad

97. The most mentioned river in early Vedic literature is:

Options:

UPSC CSE 1996

- (a) Indus
- (b) Sutudri
- (c) Saraswati
- (d) Ganga

Answer: (a) Indus

98. An inscription of the 14th century B.C. which describes the Vedic Gods has been found in:

Options: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2016

- (a) Ecbatana
- (b) Boghaz-Koi
- (c) Babylon
- (d) Bisotun

Answer: (b) Boghaz-Koi

99. The ancient name Nilotpala for Mahanadi was stated in:

Options:

Chhattisgarh PCS (Pre) 2017

- (a) Matsya Purana
- (b) Markandeya Purana

- (c) Brahma Purana
- (d) Vayu Purana

Answer: (c) Brahma Purana

100. Which of the following was considered a valuable asset during the Rigvedic period?

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) Re-exam. G.S. 2015

- (a) Land
- (b) Cow
- (c) Women
- (d) Water

Answer: (b) Cow

101. Which animal was called Aghanya during the Vedic period?

Options:

UP

UDA/LDA Spl. (Pre) 2010, UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2017

- (a) Ox
- (b) Sheep
- (c) Cow
- (d) Elephant

Answer: (c) Cow

102. The national motto of India, 'Satyameva Jayate' inscribed below the Emblem of India, is taken from:

Options:

UPSC CSE 2014

- (a) Katha Upanishad
- (b) Chandogya Upanishad
- (c) Aitareya Upanishad

- (d) Mundakopanishad

Answer: (d) Mundakopanishad

103. Which of the following Vedic texts talks about Salvation?

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2003**

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Later Samhitas
- (c) Brahmanas
- (d) Upanishads

Answer: (d) Upanishads

104. Upanishads are texts on:

Options:

UP Lower (Pre) 1998,

Uttarakhand PCS (Mains) 2004-05

- (a) Religion
- (b) Yoga
- (c) Law
- (d) Philosophy

Answer: (d) Philosophy

105. In which of the following Upanishads is the earliest mention of pessimism found?

Options:

UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006

- (a) Maitrayani
- (b) Kaushitaki
- (c) Brihadaranyaka
- (d) Kena

Answer: (a) Maitrayani

106. Reference to which of the following rivers in the Rigveda establishes the Aryans' relation with Afghanistan?

Options: **UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2010**

- (a) Asikni
- (b) Parushni
- (c) Kubha, Krumu
- (d) Vipasha, Sutudri

Answer: (c) Kubha, Krumu

107. Where is the location of the Vedic river Kubha?

Options: **UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 1999**

- (a) Afghanistan
- (b) Chinese Turkistan
- (c) Kashmir
- (d) Punjab

Answer: (a) Afghanistan

108. Reference to which of the following rivers in the Rigveda indicates that Afghanistan was part of early Vedic territory?

Options: **UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006**

- (a) Asikni & Parushni
- (b) Vipasha & Sutudri
- (c) Sindhu & Vitasta
- (d) Kubha & Suvastu

Answer: (d) Kubha & Suvastu

109. Who among the following Vedic deities was believed to be their priest?

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2013**

- (a) Agni
- (b) Brihaspati
- (c) Dyaus
- (d) Indra

Answer: (b) Brihaspati

110. Which of the following is described as the God of War in the Rigveda?

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2011**

- (a) Agni
- (b) Indra
- (c) Rudra
- (d) Vishnu

Answer: (b) Indra

111. Most of the Rigvedic hymns are devoted to:

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2002**

- (a) Agni
- (b) Indra
- (c) Rudra
- (d) Vishnu

Answer: (b) Indra

112. Who among the following was the most popular God of the early Vedic Aryans?

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2008**

- (a) Varuna

- (b) Vishnu
- (c) Rudra
- (d) Indra

Answer: (d) Indra

113. Which among the following Rigvedic deities was acknowledged as a guest?

Options: **Jharkhand PCS (Pre) G.S. 2008**

- (a) Indra
- (b) Varuna
- (c) Agni
- (d) Soma

Answer: (c) Agni

114. In Vedic rituals, Hota is associated with:

Options: **UP RO/ARO (Mains) 2013**

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Yajurveda
- (c) Samaveda
- (d) Atharvaveda

Answer: (a) Rig-Veda

115. The term 'Aryan' denotes:

Options: **UPSC CSE 1999**

- (a) An ethnic group
- (b) A nomadic people
- (c) A speech group
- (d) A superior race

Answer: (d) A superior race

116. Meaning of the word Arya in classical Sanskrit?

Options: **UP Lower (Pre) 1998**

- (a) Believer in God
- (b) A hereditary caste
- (c) Person having faith in others' religion
- (d) A noble person

Answer: (d) A noble person

117. Name the tribe which does not belong to the Panchajana of Rigvedic Aryans?

Options: **UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 1st 2009**

- (a) Yadu
- (b) Puru
- (c) Turvasa
- (d) Kikata

Answer: (d) Kikata

118. Who composed the Gayatri Mantra?

Options:

Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) G.S. 2006-07

- (a) Vashishtha
- (b) Vishwamitra
- (c) Indra
- (d) Parikshita

Answer: (b) Vishwamitra

119. In the context of ancient Indian society, which one of the following terms does not belong to the category of the other three?

Options: **UPSC CSE 1996**

- (a) Kula
- (b) Vansha
- (c) Kosha
- (d) Gotra

Answer: (c) Kosha

120. Who among the following had not participated in the Dasharajna battle?

Options: **UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006**

- (a) Tritsu
- (b) Paktha
- (c) Vishanin
- (d) Gandhari

Answer: (d) Gandhari

121. Choose the correct chronological order of the four Purusharthas:

Options: Uttarakhand PCS (Mains) 2010-11

- (a) Dharma-Kama-Artha-Moksha
- (b) Dharma-Artha-Kama-Moksha
- (c) Artha-Kama-Dharma-Moksha
- (d) Kama-Artha-Dharma-Moksha

Answer: (b) Dharma-Artha-Kama-Moksha

122. Which Vedic text first mentioned the word 'Varna'?

Options: Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) G.S. 1st 2014-15

- (a) Rig-Veda
- (b) Atharvaveda

- (c) Samaveda
- (d) Yajurveda

Answer: (a) Rig-Veda

123. The basis of untouchability during the Vedic age was:

Options:

UPPSC Asst. Forest Conservator Exam 2013

- (a) Desecration
- (b) Occupation
- (c) Poverty
- (d) None of the above

Answer: (b) Occupation

124. Rig-Veda is a:

Options: UP RO/ARO (Pre) 2016

- (a) Collection of hymns
- (b) Collection of stories
- (c) Collection of words
- (d) A book of war

Answer: (a) Collection of hymns

125. Statements about Vedic deity

Indra:

1. God of thunderstorms
2. Punished sinners
3. Guardian of moral system
4. God of rain

Options: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2017

- (a) 1 & 2 true

- (b) 1 & 3 true
- (c) 2 & 4 true
- (d) 1 & 4 true

Answer: (d) 1 & 4 true

126. War-God in Vedic Pantheon:

Options:

Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) G.S. 2016

- (a) Varuna
- (b) Indra
- (c) Mitra
- (d) Agni

Answer: (b) Indra

127. Rigvedic tribal assembly with judicial functions:

Options:

Jharkhand PSC (Pre) G.S. 2016

- (a) Sabha
- (b) Samiti
- (c) Vidatha
- (d) All

Answer: (a) Sabha

128. 'Tamso-Ma-Jyotirgamaya' belongs to:

Options:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2017

- (a) Upanishad
- (b) Chhandogya Upanishad
- (c) Puranas
- (d) Sad Darshan

Answer: (a) Upanishad

129. Upanishad meaning "white horse":

Options:

Chhattisgarh PSC (Pre) G.S. 2017

- (a) Kathopanishad
- (b) Chhandogya Upanishad
- (c) Shwetashwatar Upanishad
- (d) Isha Upanishad

Answer: (c) Shwetashwatar Upanishad

130. Medium of trade exchange in

Vedic period:

MPSC (Pre) 2023

- i. Nishka
- ii. Krishnala
- iii. Shatmana
- iv. Gana
- v. Shreni

Options:

- (a) i, ii, iii
- (b) ii, iii, iv
- (c) i, ii, iv, v
- (d) i, iii, v

Answer: (a) i, ii, iii

131. Officer known as 'Bhagadugha' in Vedic administration:

Options:

UPPCS (Pre) 2023

- (a) Chief of Forests
- (b) Revenue Collector
- (c) Messenger
- (d) Chief of Gambling Dept.

Answer: (b) Revenue Collector

132. Bhagavad Gita is part of which Mahabharata Parva?

Options: **UPPSC (Pre) 2023**

- (a) Anushasana Parva
- (b) Shanti Parva
- (c) Bhishma Parva
- (d) Drona Parva

Answer: (c) Bhishma Parva

133. Volve inscriptions refer to:

Options: **JKPSC (Pre) 2023**

- (a) Records of women's miseries
- (b) Gifts to religious institutions
- (c) Royal orders
- (d) Accounts of sacrifices

Answer: (b) Gifts to religious institutions

134. Puranas referencing ancient

Assam: **Assam PSC (Pre) 2022**

- i. Markandeya
- ii. Skanda
- iii. Naradiya
- iv. Vishnu

Options:

- (a) i & iv
- (b) Only iv
- (c) ii, iii, iv
- (d) All

Answer: (d) All

135. Later Vedic religion became more:

Options: **Mizoram PSC (Pre) 2018**

- (a) Similar
- (b) Simple
- (c) Complex
- (d) Relaxed

Answer: (c) Complex

136. Sage who Aryanized South India:

Options:

Jharkhand PSC (Pre) G.S. 2013

- (a) Vishwamitra
- (b) Agastya
- (c) Vasishta
- (d) Sambhar

Answer: (b) Agastya

137. Official NOT included in Ratnins:

Options: **UP UDA/LDA Spl. 2006**

- (a) Gramani
- (b) Mahishi
- (c) Shapati
- (d) Suta

Answer: (c) Shapati

138. Epic mentioning Krishna, son of Devaki:

Options: **RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 1999**

- (a) Mahabharata
- (b) Chhandogya Upanishad
- (c) Ashtadhyayi
- (d) Bhagavata Purana

Answer: (b) Chhandogya Upanishad

139. Legend of Satyakam Jabala is in:

Options: RAS/RTS (Pre) G.S. 2016

- (a) Chhandogya Upanishad
- (b) Jabala Upanishad
- (c) Kathopanishad
- (d) Prashnopanishad

Answer: (a) Chhandogya Upanishad

140. Ekalavya was disciple of:

Options: MPPSC (Pre) G.S. 1996

- (a) Bhishma
- (b) Parashuram
- (c) Balaram
- (d) Dronacharya

Answer: (d) Dronacharya

141. Post-Vedic development:

Options: UPSC CSE 1994

- (a) Dharma-Artha-Kama-Moksha
- (b) Brahmana-Kshatriya-Vaishya-Shudra
- (c) Brahmacharya-Grihastha-Vanaprastha-Sanyasa
- (d) Indra-Surya-Rudra-Marut

Answer: (c) Brahmacharya-Grihastha-Vanaprastha-Sanyasa

142. Sarga, Pratisarga, Vamsa, Manvantars, Vansanucharita indicate:

Options: UPPCS (Pre) Re-Exam G.S. 2015

- (a) Vedas
- (b) Puranas
- (c) Upanishads

(d) Sutras

Answer: (b) Puranas

143. Number of Puranas:

Options: UPPCS (Pre) G.S. 2009

- (a) 12
- (b) 16
- (c) 18
- (d) 20

Answer: (c) 18

144. First law-giver of India:

Options: UPPCS (Mains) G.S. 2008

- (a) Panini
- (b) Manu
- (c) Kautilya
- (d) Kapil

Answer: (b) Manu